WOLFE

THE RESEARCH BOOK

Men and women dating again after 35 in the USA, Canada and the UK. Pain points, psychology, conversation, competitors and safety resources, in one designed book. Roman Urdu summary first.



BY DORIAN WOLFE, AN AI-GENERATED CHARACTER

HOW TO READ THIS BOOK

Pehle Roman Urdu khulasa (5 pages), phir 6 poore reports (English). Har report se pehle ek opener page hai.

Strong: meta-analysis, large survey | Medium: single study, dated | Anecdotal: blogs, opinion

1. COMPETITORS
Kaun kya bech raha hai, kitne mein, aur jagah kahan khali hai.

2. FIRST SCAN
Pehle scan ke shuruati pain points.

3. PAIN POINTS REPORT
40+ mardon ka dukh, har platform se. Kya mazboot saboot hai, kya sirf kahani.

4. DATING PSYCHOLOGY REPORT
Mard kaise sochte aur aapas mein baat karte hain; pehli aur doosri date; dar aur dealbreaker.

5. 35+ CONVERSATION PSYCHOLOGY
Baat karna kyun mushkil hota hai, kaun kya pooche, aur research kya kehti hai (mard aur aurat).

6. USA / CANADA / UK RESOURCES
Helpline, scam reporting, dating customs. Search results se liye gaye: check karein.

Sab se zaroori hadd (limits)

- Reddit band tha, Instagram aur TikTok ke comments nahi mile, aur bohat si websites khulti hi nahi thi (DNS error).
- Zyada tar numbers **search summaries** se aaye hain, poore pages se nahi. Camera par koi number bolne se pehle asal source se check karein.
- 35+ ki pehli baat-cheet par almost koi research hai hi nahi. Reports mein yeh saaf likha hai.
- Helpline numbers search results se liye gaye, official sites kholkar nahi. Becne se pehle check karein.

A1. PAIN POINTS (40+ MARD)



1. Sab se bara dard akelapan hai, khaas kar divorce, bewagi ya dosti khatam hone ke baad. Yeh data se bhi saabit hai (AARP, gerontology studies), sirf kahani nahi.

2. Divorce ke baad mard ka social circle aksar biwi ke saath chala jata hai; mardon mein isolation zyada nazar aata hai, aurton mein paison ki fikr.

3. Naukri mein umar ki wajah se imtiyaz: AARP 2026 mein 50+ workers ke 64% ne age discrimination dekha ya jhela. 40-49 ka alag number nahi mila.

4. Online dating mein mard kehte hain "messages nahi aate" (Pew: 64% mard insecure), lekin yeh sab umron ka number hai, sirf 40+ ka nahi.

5. Sehat: neend ki bimari (sleep apnea), BP, annual checkup na karwana; ED aur gunjapan (baldness) ki sharam bohat hai, lekin baldness ka asli dating nateeja kisi study mein saabit nahi hua.

6. Scams: 60+ logon ke romance scam ke nuqsanat FBI ke mutabiq bohat bare hain (secondary report), mard aur aurat dono shikar hote hain.

7. Reddit band tha, Instagram/TikTok comments nahi mile, aur zyada tar websites khuli hi nahi. Isliye bohat se numbers search summary se aaye hain; unko camera par bolne se pehle asal source se check karein.

8. Pakistan/India: shaadi, "family problems", dusri shaadi, paison ka bojh aur dil/sugar ki bimari ke ishaare hain, lekin 40+ mard ka alag data bohat kam hai.

9. Jo koi nahi sikhata (gaps): roommate marriage se kaise nikalein, child support/custody ki samajh, widowers aur single dads ke liye dating, aur mardon ka in-person community.

10. Dorian Wolfe ke liye: AI hone ka saaf ailan, koi medical/ED/hair claim nahi, suicide ke baare mein safe messaging aur helpline, aur "yeh karo to yeh nateeja milega" jaise wade na karein.

A2. PSYCHOLOGY (40+ MARD)



1. Is report ka maqsad: 40+ mard kaise sochte aur mehsoos karte hain, aapas mein kaise baat karte hain, pehli aur doosri date par kya hota hai, unke dar kya hain, aur South Asian mard (Pakistan/India/diaspora) kaise alag hain.

2. Sab se bari baat: **zyada tar research search summaries aur abstracts se aayi hai**. Lagbhag har researcher ko poora web page kholne mein DNS error aaya, Reddit aur forums band the, aur 40-49 saal ya ganje (bald) mardon ka alag data lagbhag hai hi nahi.

3. Psychology: bohat mard "mazboot aur khud-nirbhar" rehne ka dabao mehsoos karte hain, jazbaat bolna mushkil hota hai (alexithymia ka farq chhota hai: d = 0.22), aur madad maangna tab asaan hota hai jab woh badle mein kuch de bhi sakein. Yeh research ka nateeja hai, 40+ dating par seedha test nahi hua.

4. Divorce ya bewagi ke baad mard aksar akele ho jate hain; divorced mard widowers se zyada akele paye gaye (Health and Retirement Study). Naya partner is akelepan ko kam karta hai.

5. Mardon ki aapas ki baat: closeness "saath kaam karne" aur mazaak/chhed-chhaad se dikhai jati hai, seedhe jazbaati lafzon se nahi. "Locker-room talk" ka ek hissa performance hai, lekin kitna, yeh kisi ne napa nahi.

6. Pehli date: sab se behtar saboot genuine sawal poochne, follow-up karne aur barabar bolne (turn-taking) ke haq mein hai. Log yeh bhi kam andaza lagate hain ke saamne wale ko woh kitne pasand aaye (liking gap). Yeh zyada tar students par hua hai, 40+ par nahi.

7. Doosri date aur aage: 50+ mein divorce ke baad mard aurton se zyada dobara partner banate hain, aksar saath rehne (cohabitation) se, shaadi se nahi. Kab exclusive hona ya bachon se milwana, iska koi pakka data nahi; "6-12 mahine" sirf rivaaj/advice hai.

8. Dar aur dealbreaker: rejection, umar, shakal, jism, paisa, scam, ex se muqabla. Mazboot data kam hai. Aurton ke dealbreaker ka koi 40+ survey nahi mila; commercial lists unverified hain.

9. Rozmarra zindagi: kaam, TV, thin savings, sehat ke checkup chhodna, aur 45-49 saal mein loneliness sab se zyada (AARP 2025: 49%). Platforms: YouTube aur Facebook.

10. South Asia: izzat, "log kya kahenge", therapy ka stigma (BACP: 51% South Asian mard), dusri shaadi ka qanooni khatra (Pakistan MFLO s.6), aur Roman Urdu mein mard-centered practical advice ki khali jagah. Lekin 40+ South Asian mardon par seedha data bohat kam hai.

11. **Do not use** (unverified): 63% ghosting, 30% divorced men date within a year, 73% romance-scam men, 85% Gen X authenticity, aur "15 questions" wala daava. Detail neeche hai.

12. Dorian Wolfe ke liye: AI hone ka saaf ailan, koi manipulation nahi, koi medical/ED/hair claim nahi, suicide-safe messaging, scam se hoshiyar, aur kisi bhi number ko camera par bolne se pehle asal source se check karein (section 11).

A3. 35+ BAAT-CHEET (MARD AUR AURAT, USA/CANADA/UK)



1. Research bohat kam hai: 35+ ki pehli baat-cheet par almost koi study nahi. Zyada tar baat-cheet ki research students ya ajnabiyon par hui hai.

2. Jo research kehti hai: follow-up sawal poochne se log zyada pasand karte hain (Huang 2017, tareeqe par behes hai); baat ke baad hum aksar kam andaza lagate hain ke saamne wale ko hum kitne pasand aaye (liking gap, Boothby 2018); aur dheere dheere zyada zaati sawal karne se qurbat badhti hai (Aron 1997, lab ka kaam).

3. Pew 2023 (US online daters, sab umr): mard zyada mehsoos karte hain ke messages kam aate hain; aurtein zyada mehsoos karti hain ke bohat zyada aate hain aur unwanted contact zyada hota hai. Exact percentages dobara pewresearch.org par check karein.

4. "Kaun pehle pooche?" ka koi mazboot saboot nahi. OkCupid 2016 ka data purana aur ek platform ka hai.

5. Mushkil topics (ex, bachche, widow/er, umar, pace) par rahnumai zyada tar advice-blogs se hai, kisi professional body (Gottman, APA, BACP) ki nahi. Kisi ka naam saboot ke taur par na likhein.

6. Dar aur mushkilein (rusty hona, guarded hona, ex se muqabla, grief) zyada tar andaza ya coaching advice hain, naapi hui research nahi.

A4. USA / CANADA / UK RESOURCES



1. UK: Action Fraud ki jagah Report Fraud 4 Dec 2025 se (reportfraud.police.uk, 0300 123 2040; Scotland: 101). Bank ki fraud line: 159.

2. USA: reportfraud.ftc.gov aur ic3.gov; crisis 988; domestic violence 1-800-799-7233.

3. Canada: Canadian Anti-Fraud Centre 1-888-495-8501; crisis 9-8-8; domestic abuse ka koi ek national number nahi, sirf provincial (Ontario ka Assaulted Women's Helpline sirf Ontario ka hai).

4. UK: Samaritans 116 123; National Domestic Abuse Helpline 0808 2000 247; Men's Advice Line 0808 801 0327; Cruse 0808 808 1677.

5. Yeh sab search results se liye gaye, official sites kholkar nahi. Becne se pehle har number check karein. Canada ki dating apps ki koi bharosemand ranking nahi mili.

A5. COMPETITORS

1. Instagram/TikTok par bare creators: @carlhuelin, @ryansaplan, @iamtonymac_, @santino.inbetween, @healthwithtom. Sab 40+ mardon, divorce aur dobara dating par baat karte hain. Unke bade reels 0.8M se 3.3M views tak gaye.

2. @marcuskanemethod (jis ko aap ne copy karna chaha) ek AI "expert" character ka faceless funnel hai, jis ke 1 hafte se kam mein 20K followers aaye. Bio funnel: reel, comment keyword, DM, guide.

3. YouTube par: Jonathon Aslay, Kimberly Hill, 2nd Act TV, Gary Gunn, PsycheMind, Iron Man Lifestyle.

4. Kaun kya bechta hai: free book ya guide se funnel, $29 ke PDF, aur $5,000+ ki coaching.

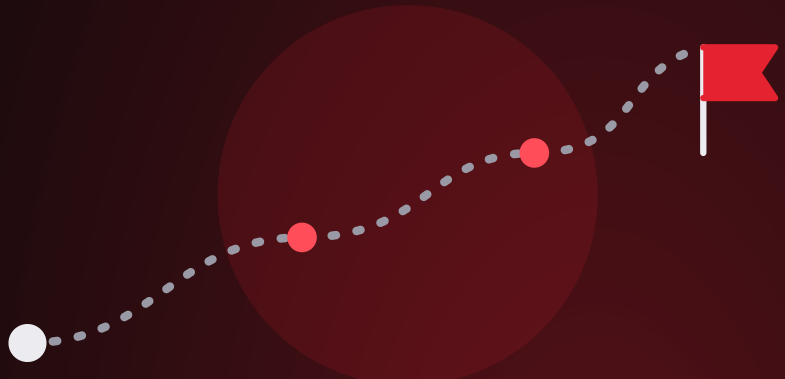
5. **Jagah khali hai:** beech ($50-300) ki range, ek ghalat dava na karne wala honest "craft" angle, aur 40+ ke liye Roman Urdu/Hinglish content.

6. Poori table, followers aur numbers section 1 mein hain.

1

COMPETITORS

Kaun kya bech raha hai, kitne mein, aur jagah kahan khali hai.



COMPETITORS: DATING, DIVORCE AND MIDLIFE CONTENT FOR MEN OVER 40 (2026-10-11)

Source: vidIQ searches (Instagram accounts from outliers, YouTube channel search) and two web searches. Audience labels are vidIQ guesses. Average views are inflated by pinned viral reels. Prices and revenues were not verified.

Instagram / TikTok (creators)

ACCOUNT	FOLLOWERS	AVG VIEWS	BIGGEST REELS	ANGLE
@carlhuelin (Carl Huelin, midlife coach)	25.9K	842K	3.3M, 3.2M plays (7K comments)	Men in 40s, dating, rebuilding life
@ryansaplan	89.1K	474K	3M plays (152.7K likes, 3.9K comments)	Own divorce journey, dating again
@iamtonymac_	77.5K	399K	3M plays (10.1K comments)	Mindset, dating after 50
@santino.inbetween	28.6K	105K	798K plays	Divorced men 40+, self-worth
@healthwithtom (Tom Palya)	48.4K	11.7K	1.4M (earlier reel)	Post-divorce rebuilding
@___startingoverat57	7.5K	5.7K	911K (TikTok)	Starting over at 57
@marcuskanemethod	about 20K	-	92K plays	AI character, male-attraction dating (format competitor, younger audience)

YouTube

CHANNEL	SUBS	AVG VIEWS	NOTES
Jonathon Aslay (@jonathonaslay)	206K	11K	Mid-life dating coach (40+), book and mentorship program
Kimberly Hill (@kimberlynhill)	87.7K	38K	Men's dating coach after divorce, free guide plus self-paced course, +78% subs in 1 year
2nd Act TV (@2ndacttv)	80.5K	8K	Over-50 dating and intimacy, expert interviews, female host
Gary Gunn (@garygunn)	76.9K	3K	UK, dating after divorce, Teachable course, mostly Shorts
PsycheMind (@psychemind222)	11.1K	15K	Faceless, "dating for men over 60", dark-psychology / red-pill framing
emlovz	52.8K	7K	Couple coaches, dating and marriage programs

CHANNEL	SUBS	AVG VIEWS	NOTES
Iron Man Lifestyle (@ironmanlifestyle)	816K	175K	India, Hinglish dating coach for Indian men, 2,500+ coached
Big general dating channels	0.8M-1.7M	70K-470K	Jessica OS, emilywking, We Said What We Said
Adjacent	about 100K	-	40+ Men's Fashion, Gary Walker (fitness for men 40+)

Also seen in earlier research: Entrepreneurs in Cars, Mike Radoor, Retired Frank, Divorce Recovery Men Over 40 podcast, The Midlife Male newsletter.

What they sell (prices unverified)

- Coaching: AARP says from $49 (self-study) to about $6,000 (1:1); another coach $5,000-12,000 for 8-12 weeks.
- Self-paced course: Kimberly Hill "Dating Mastery for Men"; Gary Gunn "Dating After Divorce 3-Month Kick-Starter" (price not found).
- Cheap PDF: a $29 guide for men 40-65 on Gumroad.
- Group: a Meetup "Singles 40+" virtual program, free first month.
- Apps (monthly): OurTime $12.99-24.99, SilverSingles $13.95-44.95, Match $18.99-45.99, eharmony and Zoosk vary. Sources conflict.

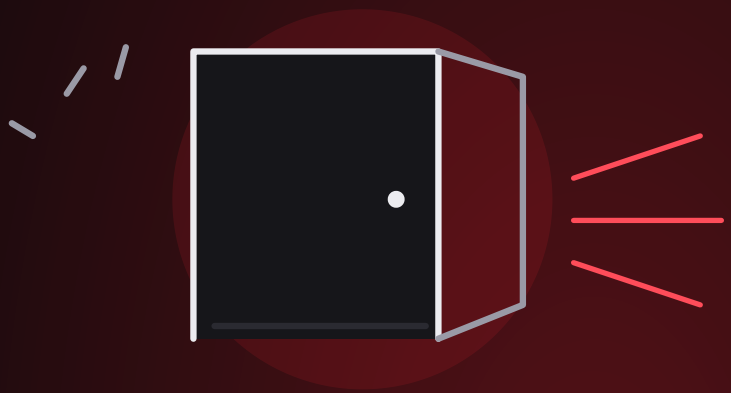
Gaps for Wolfe

- Most competitors rely on lived experience ("my divorce"). An AI character cannot claim it, so the angle must be honest craft (conversation, scam awareness).
- Nobody found combining: older and bald character, conversation skills, honest AI disclosure.
- Roman Urdu / Hinglish practical men's advice for 40+: one big Hindi-English coach for young Indian men, nothing for 40+.
- Cheap low-ticket products ($9-29) exist but are thin; mid-price ($50-300) gap.

2

FIRST SCAN

Pehle scan ke shuruati pain points.



PROBLEMS OF OLDER MEN (40-70): RESEARCH SUMMARY (2026-10-10)

Evidence quality is noted per item. Many web sources are news or company surveys, not peer-reviewed.

#	PROBLEM	EVIDENCE	VIRAL PROOF (REELS, VIEWS)
1	Loneliness, especially after divorce or widowhood	US Health and Retirement Study analysis: divorced men lonelier than widowed men. Australian HILDA data: widowed men hit hardest and stay vulnerable long. Czech study disagrees on divorce, so mixed.	@dads.matter.everywhere "wife, kids, home... still nobody" 900K; @santino.inbetween 323K, 798K
2	Gray divorce: depression, isolation, money	Bowling Green (S. Brown): gray divorce linked to more depression than widowhood. Crowley (Rutgers) 80 interviews: men report isolation, women money. Only ~37% of men re-partner in 10 years. Wealth/standard-of-living figures come from unpublished 2019 work, unverified.	@healthwithtom 19-year marriage lessons 419K; @ryansaplan divorce diary 240K
3	Widowers: guilt about dating again	Tawkify survey (645 widowed adults): average wait about 2 years, 60% felt judged. Chapter 2 survey (~15,000): about 45% often feel guilt. Both are company surveys.	n/a
4	Romance scams and being cheated	FTC Dec 2025 older-adults report: losses of people 60+ went from about $0.6B (2020) to $2.4B (2024). Pew 2023: 47% of online daters 50+ met a suspected scammer. No gender split found.	n/a
5	Sexual confidence, body image, "am I still attractive"	Cleveland Clinic 2022 survey: 44% of men worry about ED, 58% wrongly blame low testosterone; over 50, ED is more often a heart-health issue. Perth cohort (75-95): about 20% anxious about performance. Australian survey: ED hits confidence and self-image.	Bald angle: @xtheromanempire 4.7M, @viktortass 2.5M, @lizcoin 1.4M
6	Work, money, purpose	Reels about job loss after 50 and retirement dread.	@rajiydscpb6 756K; @man.over.50 213K; @digital_journey26 163K; @marktheeaffiliate 245K
7	Identity and "midlife tunnel"	Creator content, no study found.	@new.man.codes 479K IG, 217K TikTok

Sources

- Loneliness (PMC7489102): https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC7489102
- Gray divorce and Crowley: https://bloustein.rutgers.edu/two-different-divorces-dr-jocelyn-elise-crowley-analyzes-how-divorce-over-the-age-of-50-produces-different-impacts-for-men-and-women-in-thrive-magazine-winter-spring-2026/

- FTC older adults report: https://www.ftc.gov/system/files/ftc_gov/pdf/P144400-OlderAdultsReportDec2025.pdf
- Pew, dating at 50+: https://www.pewresearch.org/short-reads/2023/07/17/dating-at-50-and-up-older-americans-experiences-with-online-dating/markdown
- Cleveland Clinic men's sexual health survey: https://newsroom.clevelandclinic.org/2022/09/07/sexual-health-big-concern-for-men-survey-finds-pkg
- Perth cohort: https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/22145992/
- Tawkify widowed survey: https://tawkify.com/blog/dating/widowed-dating

Gaps

- No study found specific to men over 60 who are widowed and dating.
- No gender breakdown of romance scam losses.
- Sales and revenue data for competitors was not available.

3

PAIN POINTS REPORT

40+ mardon ka dukh, har platform se. Kya mazboot saboot hai, kya sirf kahani.



Evidence behind each pain point



Bar = how well the evidence holds up (my ranking from the report, not a measured frequency). Full table in the report.

ISOLATED, BROKE AND UNSEEN: WHAT HURTS MEN OVER 40

Men over 40 hurt most from **isolation that follows a loss** (divorce, widowhood, a fading circle of friends), and from **a job and money squeeze that arrives at the same time**. Next come a dating market that feels closed to them, bodies they are not checking (sleep, blood pressure, sexual function, hair), and a silence about all of it. The data are strongest for divorce, loneliness, age bias at work, scams against people 60+, and online-dating message gaps. They are weakest exactly where a dating-advice brand would most like proof: baldness in real dating outcomes, widowers, "approach anxiety" after a long marriage, and anything specific to men aged 40-49. The loudest video hooks (divorce diaries, "I'm 55 and can't find a job", "being single isn't the problem") match the data on divorce and age bias. The comments under them show a different

mood: many men say they are "addicted to peace" and will never live with anyone again, while others admit they think about being cheated on every day. Almost no creator answers the practical questions men actually ask: how to leave a dead marriage without losing the house, what child support and custody really involve, where to meet other men in person, and what to do as a widower or single dad. The research behind this report is thin in places. Most pages could not be opened (DNS errors), Reddit was blocked, Instagram and TikTok comments were unavailable, and many figures come from search summaries or secondary news copies. Every such flag is carried below, and nothing has been upgraded.

Roman Urdu summary

1. Sab se bara dard akelapan hai, khaas kar divorce, bewagi ya dosti khatam hone ke baad. Yeh data se bhi saabit hai (AARP, gerontology studies), sirf kahani nahi.
2. Divorce ke baad mard ka social circle aksar biwi ke saath chala jata hai; mardon mein isolation zyada nazar aata hai, aurton mein paison ki fikr.
3. Naukri mein umar ki wajah se imtiyaz: AARP 2026 mein 50+ workers ke 64% ne age discrimination dekha ya jhela. 40-49 ka alag number nahi mila.
4. Online dating mein mard kehte hain "messages nahi aate" (Pew: 64% mard insecure), lekin yeh sab umron ka number hai, sirf 40+ ka nahi.
5. Sehat: neend ki bimari (sleep apnea), BP, annual checkup na karwana; ED aur gunjapan (baldness) ki sharam bohat hai, lekin baldness ka asli dating nateeja kisi study mein saabit nahi hua.
6. Scams: 60+ logon ke romance scam ke nuqsanat FBI ke mutabiq bohat bare hain (secondary report), mard aur aurat dono shikar hote hain.
7. Reddit band tha, Instagram/TikTok comments nahi mile, aur zyada tar websites khuli hi nahi. Isliye bohat se numbers search summary se aaye hain; unko camera par bolne se pehle asal source se check karein.
8. Pakistan/India: shaadi, "family problems", dusri shaadi, paison ka bojh aur dil/sugar ki bimari ke ishaare hain, lekin 40+ mard ka alag data bohat kam hai.
9. Jo koi nahi sikhata (gaps): roommate marriage se kaise nikalein, child support/custody ki samajh, widowers aur single dads ke liye dating, aur mardon ka in-person community.
10. Dorian Wolfe ke liye: AI hone ka saaf ailan, koi medical/ED/hair claim nahi, suicide ke baare mein safe messaging aur helpline, aur "yeh karo to yeh nateeja milega" jaise wade na karein.

How strong is the evidence? Ranked pain points

The ranking below is my judgement. It combines how consistently a pain appeared across platforms with how well the numbers hold up. It is not a measured frequency: no Reddit counts, upvotes, or TikTok/Instagram comment data were obtainable. "Strong" means peer-reviewed or official data exist, though even those were often read only through search summaries. "Medium" means a real source exists but it is secondary, dated, not specific to men 40+, or

contested. "Anecdotal" means the support is comments, advice columns, blogs, commercial surveys or a few viral videos.

#	PAIN POINT	EVIDENCE	KEY NUMBERS AND SOURCES	HOW MEN PHRASE IT	WHERE SEEN
1	Loneliness and lost friends, especially after divorce	Strong for loneliness and divorce; medium for "no friends" claim	AARP survey of adults 45+: 40% lonely, men 42% vs women 37% (year not shown; syndicated copy only) (Scripps News). Divorced men lonelier than widowed men in Health and Retirement Study data; new partnership narrows gap (J Gerontol B 2020). Dutch study: men divorced before or after midlife more socially lonely than continuously married men (PMC12439737). Contested: Pew (2024 survey) finds men not lonelier than women and adults under 50 lonelier than 50+ (22% vs 9%) (Pew)	"In my 20's I stayed out late because I didn't want to go home to an empty house. In my 50's I go home early because my house is empty." (YouTube comment, 397 likes); headline "I'm a man in my 40s and feel like I don't have any real friendships"	YouTube comments, Irish Times column, TikTok/IG hooks, official data
2	Gray divorce and its aftermath (isolation, money, kids)	Strong	Share of divorcing persons aged 50+ rose from 8% (1990) to nearly 40%; rate roughly tripled (BGSU). Men's wealth/standard-of-living losses last longer and repartnering restored women's but not men's wealth (summary of HRS work) (Rutgers)	"Lonely, but still way, way better" (Reddit user quoted by BuzzFeed; speaker's sex unconfirmed); "As a 49-year-old divorced dad of two, these 6 things hit harder than I ever expected"	Instagram/TikTok outliers, BuzzFeed, official data
3	Work: age bias, job loss, starting over	Strong for workers 50+; no clean 40-49 cut	AARP 2026 poll of 1,656 workers 50+: 64% saw or experienced age discrimination, 22% felt pushed out (AARP). Unemployment men 55+ 2.9% (AARP digest of BLS data) (AARP)	"I'M 55 YEARS OLD, AND FOR THE FIRST TIME IN MY LIFE, I CAN'T SEEM TO FIND A JOB"; "I'm a late 40s white male and feel erased" (search snippet, mirror not opened)	TikTok, Reddit snippet, AARP
4	Dating market feels closed: few messages, apps that cost money	Medium: strong all-age Pew data, not split for 40+	Pew 2023 (all ages): 64% of men felt insecure about too few messages vs about 4 in 10 women (Pew). About half of men 50-64 who tried online dating have paid (Pew). AARP-cited Pew figure: 38% of men over 50 say experiences were negative (secondary) (AARP)	Matches but "it never gets passed the conversation", "I have not had sex in almost a year" (37-year-old, YouTube comment insight); "I'm over 40 and I'm over dating my peace is non negotiable"	YouTube comments, Pew, TikTok

#	PAIN POINT	EVIDENCE	KEY NUMBERS AND SOURCES	HOW MEN PHRASE IT	WHERE SEEN
5	Money fear: thin savings, divorce costs, legal system	Medium (figures are Gen X or household level, not men only); fear of family courts is anecdotal	Gen X median retirement savings about $13,000 for men vs $6,000 for women (Alliance for Lifetime Income via Yahoo Finance); a different survey gives $10,000 for all Gen X households, so the two do not match (Benzinga). A 47-year-old engineer dreads untangling "finances and losing the house" (comment, 5 likes)	"Family law is unfair. Divorce is a financial shake down AND the men lose the kids." (50 likes); "You can't afford to retire... But you're exhausted"	YouTube comments, TikTok, surveys
6	Suicide, depression, untreated distress, alcohol	Strong that the burden is real; male 45-64 and 65+ rates not retrieved; causes anecdotal	Male suicide rate 22.7 per 100,000 in 2023, highest among men 75+ (CDC NCHS). Provisional 2022: rates rose for males 35+ (secondary, ABC7). Of men 40-54 who died by suicide in England in 2017, 91% had contact with a frontline service and 57% had economic problems (Manchester NCISH). Treatment gap: 59% of men with daily anxiety or depression neither take medication nor see a professional (2017) (CDC blog)	"Emotions come out sideways": irritability, numbness, "I'm fine"; ("something feels stuck" is therapist-blog phrasing, not a man's quote)	Therapist blogs, podcasts, CDC
7	Neglected body: weight, sleep apnea, no checkups, low-T hype	Medium	Obesity 46.4% at ages 40-59 (secondary report of CDC data) (ABC30). 44% of men skip an annual physical (Cleveland Clinic 2023, via WebMD). Undiagnosed sleep apnea in men 40-69 estimated up to 49% in one cohort paper (PMC5103243). Life expectancy men 75.8 vs women 81.1 in 2023 (NCHS DB521)	"50 Year Olds Are Dying! Let's Fight!"; "After 60, You Only Have 12 GOOD Years Left" (hooks, not quotes from ordinary men)	TikTok/IG hooks, surveys
8	Sexual function and shame (ED, desire)	Medium: prevalence data are dated, shame data are secondary	Massachusetts Male Aging Study (men 40-70, 1987-89): 35% moderate to complete ED, 52% at least some (dated, secondary) (PMC8964411). Analysis of about 8,000 Reddit men's-health posts: "anxiety" 432 times, "embarrassed" 95, "shame" 55; commissioned by a Canadian ED-drug seller, not limited to 40+ (NOW Toronto). UK poll "91% felt shame" is unverified (YEP)	Shame and anxiety, not specific quotes	Search summaries; one TikTok Shop "natural ED" review (153K views) shows supplement selling
9	Looks: baldness, ageing, confidence	Medium for first-impression effects; anecdotal for real dating outcomes	Mannes (Wharton, three experiments): shaved men rated more dominant, digitally shaved men seen as nearly an inch taller and 13% stronger, but less attractive and nearly four years older (NBC News). Korean study: balding men rated older and less attractive by over 90% of respondents (hair-loss forum reprint, secondary) (HairLossTalk)	"I'm 51 - Men over 40 should be more vain" (video title, 15K views)	YouTube, lab studies; the earlier summary lists bald-angle reels with millions of views (see note below)

#	PAIN POINT	EVIDENCE	KEY NUMBERS AND SOURCES	HOW MEN PHRASE IT	WHERE SEEN
10	Romance scams and being cheated or cheated on	Strong that scams are large; not sex-split	FBI IC3 2024 (secondary coverage, report not opened): losses for people over 60 about $4.9 billion, romance losses $389 million (unconfirmed) (AARP). Scams reach men and women 50+ about equally (Pew)	"Was married with a child, she cheated. That was over 20 years ago, still think about it every day multiple times." (184 likes)	YouTube comments, FBI/Pew
11	Family: estrangement, grown kids, widower guilt	Medium (estrangement); anecdotal or commercial (widowers)	27% estranged from a close relative, up to 10% from a parent or child (Pillemer 2020, via Economist). 26% estranged from fathers vs 6% from mothers, but retrospective and ever-estranged (PMC10254574). Widowers: guilt about dating, "cheating on my children" worry, from blogs and a commercial app's survey (45% guilt, sample mostly widows) (AOL)	"My wife passed away last year... I thought about dating, but..." (7 likes); "I'm 68, my wife passed in November of 2025. I won't get with anyone again." (11 likes)	Advice columns, YouTube comments
12	Identity, purpose and the midlife dip	Medium and contested	Economists find a U-shaped life-satisfaction curve, with a low point in midlife, comparable in size to job loss or widowhood (GLO); other psychologists call it overblown (PMC8525618)	"Midlife tunnel" (TikTok title, 217K views; phrase not found elsewhere); "Life 2.0" (one comment)	TikTok, essays, podcasts
13	Caregiving and ageing parents	Medium for scale; thin for men	63 million US caregivers, nearly 1 in 4 adults; about 3 in 5 are women (AARP/NAC 2025) (AARP). 73% of "sandwich" adults 40-59 adjusted retirement goals (insurer survey) (Athene)	Not found in any comment sample	Surveys only
14	South Asia: household pressure, second marriage, health	Medium (India suicide data, UK cardiometabolic); anecdotal (rishta, second marriage, Gulf)	Men about 73% of India's 2023 suicide deaths (secondary legal article citing NCRB) (Legal Service India). UK South Asian men develop heart disease about 8 years earlier than white men (60.4 vs 68.2) (Buckinghamshire DPH report). "Dusri Shaadi		Second Marriage" Short: 1.66M views (YouTube)

One note about table row 9: the earlier research summary listed bald-angle reels at 4.7M, 2.5M and 1.4M views. Those view counts are carried over from that summary, whose main source was not re-checked in the folder notes, so treat them as unverified. The folder's own video search found no qualifying bald-man outliers.

The money, work and body squeeze arrives all at once

The strongest official numbers sit in work and divorce. AARP's 2026 poll found that **64% of workers 50+ saw or experienced age discrimination**, 22% felt pushed out, and 91% of those who saw it called it common (AARP). That is workers 50+ of both sexes; men 40-49 are not

isolated in it. A 2023 wave reported 62%, and 15% said they were not hired in the prior two years because of age; these waves are not strictly comparable (ABC News 4). Long-term unemployment is also more common among jobseekers 55+, at 28.2% versus 26.2% for those under 55 (ambiguous year, not sex-split; AARP digest linked above). On TikTok the same pain went viral through confessions with an age in the first line: the @man.over.50 clip (213K views, 131x the creator's median) and a "Half Of Us Can't Get Hired After 50" clip (202K views) (vidIQ). The Reddit evidence is a single r/Layoffs thread seen only as a search snippet.

Savings data show why the fear feels real, though they do not isolate men. Gen X (roughly 45-60) holds median retirement savings of about $13,000 for men and $6,000 for women in one study, and only 14% have a traditional pension (Yahoo Finance). A separate survey expects Gen X to accumulate about $602,944 against a stated need of roughly $1.07 million (401k Specialist). Divorce multiplies the risk: in gray-divorce data both sexes lose about half their wealth, women's standard of living falls further, but men's losses last longer and men do not regain wealth by repartnering (paraphrased from a search summary of Health and Retirement Study work) (J Gerontol B). A YouTube description's claim that men's standard of living fell 21% vs women's 45% after gray divorce is unverified, and the same description's claim that 64% of midlife-divorced men called it the best decision of their lives is also unverified. Commenters repeat the fear without prompting: "Divorce is a financial shake down AND the men lose the kids" (50 likes) and a 47-year-old engineer who dreads separating finances and losing the house.

The body is the quieter half of the squeeze. Obesity prevalence peaks at ages 40-59 at 46.4% (ABC30), 44% of men skip an annual physical (WebMD), and an Australian cohort paper estimates that undiagnosed sleep apnea in men 40-69 could be as high as 49% (an estimate, not a measured rate) (PMC5103243). Cleveland Clinic's 2022 survey reported that 71% of men with sexual-health concerns also had cardiovascular disease or diabetes, so sexual worry and heart risk overlap (Cleveland Clinic). Low-testosterone marketing is a documented hazard: prevalence ranges from 0.1% at ages 40-49 (European Male Aging Study) to about 30% under broad definitions (BMC Surgery), and an endocrinologist quoted by NPR called low-T clinics "sex hormone factories" (KFF Health News). Prevalence studies cited are from 2012-2014 or older.

Loneliness is real, but "men have no friends" is overstated

Almost every platform converged on isolation, which makes it the best single pain to build on. Official data support it for the divorced: divorced men were lonelier than widowed men in Health and Retirement Study data, and the difference vanished for women (J Gerontol B 2020). Rutgers' Jocelyn Crowley found in interviews that men are more likely to be socially isolated after gray divorce while women worry more about money (Rutgers). The mechanism, men losing a shared network and leaning on one partner for social life, is an inference; no study retrieved tested it. Psychiatrist Richard Schwartz compared isolation's health effect to smoking, high blood pressure and obesity (WBUR). The Surgeon General's 2023 advisory figures (social

isolation linked to 29% higher risk of premature death, loneliness 26%) come only from news reprints here (Chief Healthcare Executive).

The popular statistic is less solid than it looks. "15% of men have no close friends, up from 3% in 1990" comes from one May 2021 survey of all men 18+, taken during COVID, with 6+ close friends falling from 55% to 27% (Fox News). One column pairs it with a different "10+ friends" metric (40% to 15%), and the two 15% figures must not be conflated. Pew's 2024 survey found men do not report feeling lonely more than women (Pew), and the Australian Psychological Society says loneliness peaks for men in middle age but that "male loneliness epidemic" framing is weaker than claimed (psychology.org.au). Gallup's men-specific number (25% of men 15-34 lonely "a lot of the previous day") is for young men, not 40+ (Gallup). The honest line is: loneliness after divorce is well supported; "a friendship recession among middle-aged men" is plausible but contested.

The YouTube comments add texture the surveys cannot. Under a 506,000-view video about older Gen X men living alone (channel Forged in Silence, 16.1K subscribers), the top-liked comments mostly express contentment: "Im 48. And addicted to peace and quietness" (1,209 likes), "Alone, not lonely. Happy and content. Was married for 28 years" (636 likes) (vidIQ). Yet beside them sit "In my 50's I go home early because my house is empty" (397 likes) and men who think daily about a spouse's affair from 20 years ago. My reading is that "peace" is partly a defence, since the two moods sit in the same threads, but that is interpretation. This sample is three YouTube videos from a male-audience channel set, some leaning men's-rights or MGTOW; it overstates hostility toward women. Commenter ages are self-stated and unverified.

Dating after 40: the market is hard, but the proof is thin

Pew gives the best dating numbers, and all are broader than 40+. Among all ages, **64% of men felt insecure about too few messages** in 2023 against about 4 in 10 women, and 54% of women felt overwhelmed by volume against about a quarter of men (Pew). A 2020 Pew wave found 57% of men vs 24% of women said they got too few messages, using different wording and a different window, so the figures should not be merged (Pew 2020). Among adults 50+, 17% had ever used a dating app (2022 survey, n=6,034), about half of men 50-64 who tried it had paid, and men and women 50+ were about equally likely to have met scams (Pew). The earlier summary also cites 47% of online daters 50+ meeting a suspected scammer (Pew 2023) and an FTC figure that losses of people 60+ rose from about $0.6 billion (2020) to $2.4 billion (2024); neither was re-checked in this round, and neither is sex-split (FTC). No app-company data on ghosting, age filters or fake profiles for men 40+ were found.

On the other side of the market, no representative survey of what women say about men 40+ exists in the notes. What exists is opinion and bias: a men's lifestyle blog arguing women in their 40s want men who listen and manage emotions (The Modest Man), and a self-selected Threads poll of 141 women, host-reported, that "90% would not date separated men", which is not representative (Audible listing). Caregiving avoidance has real support: researchers report that women who nursed parents or husbands often prefer living apart together to avoid doing it

again (Missouri News). The "nurse or purse" label itself was not found in a source. Men's own fear of "baggage" and of competing with younger men appears only on a blog the search tool flagged as low quality, so it stays anecdotal.

The big gap in evidence is on the first conversation. Nobody supplied research on approach anxiety, small talk, or "not knowing the rules" after a long marriage, so those remain plausible but unproven. Repartnering is real: men who divorce at 50+ were about twice as likely as women to remarry within the same year (3.8% vs 1.9%), but that is a one-year share, not a lifetime rate (NCFMR). The earlier summary states that only about 37% of men re-partner within 10 years; I did not re-verify it and it conflicts in spirit with "repartnering is common, especially among men" (PMC7489102), so neither claim should be quoted without a primary check.

Baldness gets the loudest personal treatment and the weakest proof of real-life effect. In the Wharton experiments, shaved heads read as more dominant, taller and stronger but less attractive and older (NBC News). The first experiment used 59 college students rating 25 photos (CBC). The study compared shaved with full hair, not shaved with thinning, so it cannot support the claim that a clean shave beats thinning hair. The Korean and Bucknell studies, both known through secondary pages, found balding men rated older and less attractive (Bucknell blog), while a sponsored dating-site survey of 2,000 women ranking a bald head second among appealing traits is commissioned and not peer reviewed (Jamaica Gleaner). A 2019 International Journal of Trichology finding that hair loss lowers quality of life is itself from an unverified FAQ (Calendar UK). Real match rates by hair status were not found anywhere.

Men 65 and older: a separate, thinly covered group

The notes cover men 65+ unevenly, so this section keeps to what was found. About a third of online daters 65+ (men and women) reported at least one of four unwanted behaviours, and a similar share of men 65+ as men 50-64 had paid for a dating platform (Pew). Romance-scam losses are counted for ages 60+ and not by sex: FBI 2024 coverage lists $389 million in romance losses for over-60s, unconfirmed (AARP). Suicide rates are highest among men 75+ (22.7 per 100,000 for all men in 2023) (CDC NCHS), and the male-female life-expectancy gap at 65 narrows to 2.5 years from 5.3 at birth (gap values from secondary summaries) (NCHS DB521). Widowers appear in the comments as men who "won't get with anyone again" (68-year-old, 11 likes), and the one commercial widower survey is mostly of widows. A Belonging Forum summary says men 55-64 are the most likely to report no close friends (Belonging Forum summary, snippet only) (Belonging Forum). No study of widowed men over 60 who are dating was found, and no video outlier was addressed to widowers.

South Asia: signals are real, but evidence is thinnest here

English-only search reached almost no Urdu or Hindi sources, so this section is a set of leads. India's NCRB-based figures show men at about **73% of 2023 suicide deaths** (a legal-service article citing NCRB) (Legal Service India), most male victims married (68.4% in 2019) (The

Week), and "family problems" the largest recorded cause at 23.06% of all suicides in 2015-2022, an undefined category (Newslaundry). A Supreme Court petition's higher figures (33.2% of male suicides from family problems) are the petitioner's claim and unverified (The Mooknayak). Pakistan had no comparable male suicide data in the notes. A 2011 review's 21.7% male depression prevalence versus 45.5% female is old, small and may reflect diagnostic bias (JCPSP); I found no source for the phrase "mard ko dard nahi hota", so it stays an assumption.

Divorce is rising in Pakistani courts (Punjab khula cases 13,299 in 2012 to 18,901 in 2016; Sindh 11,639 in 2020 to 16,287 the next year), but there is no national database and the rise partly reflects easier filing; figures came through a Wikipedia article and news summaries (Wikipedia, Express Tribune). India's 498A "misuse" grievance is a real grassroots movement but contested, with no independently verified national false-case or custody data; the provision is now Section 85 of the BNS (MyJoyOnline). Second marriage is both a pain and a legal hazard: in Pakistan a man needs the first wife's permission and marrying without it can bring jail and fines (Daily Pakistan). Health leads are firmer: UK South Asian men develop cardiovascular disease about eight years earlier than white men, diabetes risk matches white risk at a BMI near 23.9 versus 30, and up to 40% of cases may be undiagnosed (Buckinghamshire DPH); the survey figures on Pakistani men (diabetes 22.4%) are older (2000s-2010s) (Diabetes on the Net).

On attention, vidIQ queries on Roman Urdu terms found that "second marriage" and "shohar/biwi" Shorts draw large views, but mostly from religious-advice and drama channels: a 1.66M-view Short by Lubena Firdos (YouTube) and a 952K-view Mufti Tariq Masood clip (YouTube). Audience gender is unknown, and they may be watched mostly by wives. A "hakeem" Short tagged "mardana taqat" drew only 15K views. Pakistan's Facebook audience is about 75.5% male (ad-audience estimate, volatile) (NapoleonCat), so Facebook and YouTube Shorts look like plausible reach platforms for men 40+, but that is inference, not age data. The Gulf-returnee leads (distress from returning as a "failure" in a 2022 study of 330 Indian return migrants, per search summary) are thin (IJCMPH).

What nobody is serving (gaps)

Gaps are listed in three kinds: content nobody makes, evidence nobody has, and audiences nobody addresses. Each is marked by how it was found. Absence in a small sample is not proof of unmet demand.

The first kind is practical, from the YouTube comment samples. No sampled hook addressed leaving a "roommate marriage" with money and house logistics; one 47-year-old engineer asked "How did you end it brother?" and got two likes. None covered what child support and custody involve (one commenter paid since his early 20s; state supports to age 21, per his comment), or the daily rumination after being cheated on, where the creator's reply was "maybe it's worth trying one more time?". Men asked for in-person meetups and men's seminars (4 and 7 likes), other men's stories, and a "what comes next" plan ("Life 2.0"). Each of these themes had only one or two threads in the vidIQ discover sample, which the tool itself calls thin. These are directional only.

The second kind is audiences. Widowers and single dads have commenters (a 58-year-old single dad called "incel" for not dating; two widowers who said they will not date) but no outlier videos. In the folder's video search, queries on bald-man dating, widowers, adult-kid fatherhood, ageing parents and ED confidence returned nothing at outlier scale, but those queries were not run separately, so absence is not conclusive. Commercial coaching content exists (Mike Radoor's keyword-DM coaching, Entrepreneurs in Cars' Calendly coaching and supplements) and one creator's own description says content for divorced men is "either selling you a playbook or pretending the loneliness will go away if you just download the apps" (vidIQ). That is one creator's description, not survey evidence of distrust. Free, peer-led, non-coach, non-crisis spaces for men 40-65 look scarce: the notes found a divorce-recovery podcast with a private Facebook group, The Midlife Male newsletter, and paid group therapy (Ausha, Therapy Den), but membership sizes, Men's Sheds and Movember programs were not researched.

The third kind is language. Practical, non-judgmental men's advice in Roman Urdu or Hinglish appeared absent from the two vidIQ queries run; high-view results were religious or drama. This is an inference from a small sample and no named Urdu/Hindi men's-advice creator list was built. Women creators drive some of the largest numbers about men 40+ (a woman reacting to a divorced man's video reached 1.8M TikTok views), so the male voice itself is not the default supplier (vidIQ).

Ethical cautions for a creator

This audience carries real vulnerability, and several signals in the notes call for restraint rather than growth tactics. Suicide risk is concentrated among older men, and one Reddit post found in a search carried language suggesting suicidal thoughts. The Manchester study shows that most men who died had contacted a service and half had economic problems, which argues against content that says men "don't seek help" (NCISH). Follow safe-messaging practice: no method detail, no glamorising ending it, no "just be strong" framing, and show a crisis line (988 in the US, local lines elsewhere) on any content about despair, divorce loss or "nobody cares". Do not treat advocacy claims about suicide causes (e.g. the 498A petition figures) as fact.

Scams and predation are the second hazard. People 60+ face large reported losses, men and women are about equally exposed, and the audience, divorced, lonely and paying for apps, is exactly what romance scammers and "dating coach" upsells target. Do not minimise this, never promise a partner or "high-value woman", and be wary of the "double life", "spinning plates" and "don't let her bully you" hooks that creators in this niche use; treating women as opponents is also a brand risk, and the India and Pakistan material shows how fast "men's rights" framing reads as anti-women (MyJoyOnline). Content encouraging marriages hidden from a first wife could expose a creator to complaints in Pakistan, and Pakistani and Indian obscenity or cyber-crime laws on sexual content were not checked; get a legal check before publishing there.

No medical claims. FDA has repeatedly found undeclared sildenafil or tadalafil in "natural" sex supplements, with reports of strokes, kidney failure and death (NBC News), and NCCIH says no herbal product has definite evidence for ED (NCCIH). Pakistan has restricted hakeem and

sexual-debility advertising (PEMRA 2016, DRAP; enforcement unclear) (Journalism Pakistan). Do not diagnose, name drugs or doses, interpret labs, recommend testosterone or hair treatments, or imply ED can be fixed by confidence; point men to a doctor, since ED can flag heart disease. Also avoid specific investment, tax or divorce-law advice, and refer to professionals.

AI disclosure is part of the honesty brand. "Dorian Wolfe" is an AI character, so say so plainly in the bio and in each video, never invent personal stories, ages or "lessons from my divorce", and never present invented quotes as real men's words. Using the personal-confession format that is outperforming everywhere ("I'm 55 and...") would be deceptive if voiced by an AI as lived experience, so adapt the hook to speak about men's experiences rather than claim one. Finally, do not turn small, self-selected or commercial numbers into facts: the 141-woman poll, the HairLossTalk reprint, Chapter 2 and Tawkify surveys, and the sponsored bald-appeal poll are all biased.

Content and product implications

The hooks that performed share a pattern: a first-person confession with an age and a number, or a blunt reframe that offers relief rather than a fix, over a still image or talking head under two minutes. @healthwithtom's divorce-lessons reel reached 1.4M views (32x the creator median) and @starting.over.at.57's "wrong person" video 911K (473x) (vidIQ), but the biggest multiples came from accounts with 1K-90K followers, which suggests topic, not brand, drives reach. Outlier multiples are vidIQ's and audience labels are AI-inferred. These patterns do not guarantee results for a new AI character, and nothing here promises views, growth or sales.

Link each pain to a hook that fits Dorian's honest tone without claiming a fix. For loneliness after divorce: "The house is quiet at 10 pm. Here is what men say at that hour" (a theme from comments, with care not to quote any commenter as if they were Dorian). For age bias: "Half of workers over 50 report age bias, and here is how to talk about your experience in an interview" (AARP's 64% is workers 50+, so say that, not "men over 40"). For online dating: "Most men feel the message gap: it is not just you" (Pew's 64% is all-age men). For conversation advice: how to carry a first conversation after years of marriage, the one skill the notes show nobody has measured and no creator teaches, so the brand's value is the honest craft, not a claimed statistic. For baldness: lead with what is known and unknown, e.g. "Studies disagree on bald men; the shaved head read as dominant in one experiment". For health: "Ask your doctor about sleep and blood pressure", not remedies. For scams: "Five signs a dating profile is a scam".

For products, the evidence points to low-risk formats rather than a promise. Candidates drawn from the gaps are a plain-language checklist for the first conversation (open-ended starters, listening, how to end well), a "dating after divorce" etiquette guide covering exes, kids and adult children's reactions without legal advice, a scam-awareness guide with referral to official reporting, and a men's meetup directory or facilitated peer-circle, which commenters explicitly asked for and which the notes found no public peer-led version of. Roman Urdu and Hinglish versions are the clearest language gap, but the notes show demand only indirectly (religious

and drama channels draw views), so test with a few short clips before building. Any product that touches second marriage, sexual health or family law needs legal and medical review first and should not suggest a first wife can be bypassed.

Where evidence is weak, content should say so openly, which suits an honest brand: state the study, its size and its limit ("a lab study of 59 students", "one 2021 survey"). Verify every figure against its primary page before it goes on camera, because the notes record that most figures came from search summaries. Handle the supplement-selling lane carefully: it already exists, as in a 153K-view TikTok Shop "natural ED" review, and the NCCIH and FDA warnings above say why trust, not claims, is the opening.

What remains uncertain, and what to verify first

The largest unknowns are the exact ones the creator needs. Nothing retrieved isolates men 40-49 on loneliness, dating, work or divorce finance; most figures cover ages 50+, 45+, Gen X or all adults. Reddit, Facebook group, Quora and Medium text, plus Instagram and TikTok comments, were unreachable, so how men actually phrase their pain rests on YouTube comments (three videos plus a sampled run), search-snippet quotes, and advice columns. No frequency ranking is possible; the table order is a judgement. Several statistics need primary checks before use: the Surgeon General's 26% and 29% figures, the FBI IC3 totals, the Pew 47% suspected-scammer and 38% negative-experience figures, the claimed 37% repartnering in ten years, the Gen X savings numbers, the 2021 friendship survey, and the earlier summary's bald-reel view counts. Recommended next steps are a Reddit-capable pull on r/FriendsOver40, r/AskMenOver40, r/DivorcedDads and r/widowers; Instagram and TikTok comment export on the top divorce and job-loss reels; separate vidIQ queries for bald dating, widowers, ED and ageing parents; and an Urdu and Hindi review of Dawn, BBC Urdu and local forums.

Conclusion

The research changes the brief in one way: the most fundable pain is not "how do I get a date" but "how do I stop being alone without being fooled or ashamed", and that sits between data and silence. Loneliness after divorce, age bias at work and the message gap on dating apps are documented; the first awkward conversation, the bald man's real match rate, the widower's timeline and the South Asian 40+ man's dilemmas are not. A creator who says plainly which is which will be telling men something no one else in this space bothers to, and the audience's own phrase, "I'm done, my peace is non negotiable", is a fair warning that overpromising about love will lose them.

The second lesson is that honesty is itself the gap. Many of the highest-performing voices pair vulnerable confession with a coaching offer, a supplement or a "playbook", and viewers have started to notice. For an openly AI character, the credible position is the reverse: no lived-experience claims, no outcome promises, careful sourcing, and a steady pointer to doctors, lawyers, crisis lines and real men in real rooms.

4

DATING PSYCHOLOGY REPORT

Mard kaise sochte aur aapas mein baat karte hain; pehli aur doosri date; dar aur dealbreaker.



DECODING MEN OVER 40: MINDS, BANTER, DATES, SOUTH ASIA

Roman Urdu summary (taqreeban 12 lines)

1. Is report ka maqsad: 40+ mard kaise sochte aur mehsoos karte hain, aapas mein kaise baat karte hain, pehli aur doosri date par kya hota hai, unke dar kya hain, aur South Asian mard (Pakistan/India/diaspora) kaise alag hain.
2. Sab se bari baat: **zyada tar research search summaries aur abstracts se aayi hai**. Lagbhag har researcher ko poora web page kholne mein DNS error aaya, Reddit aur forums band the, aur 40-49 saal ya ganje (bald) mardon ka alag data lagbhag hai hi nahi.
3. Psychology: bohat mard "mazboot aur khud-nirbhar" rehne ka dabao mehsoos karte hain, jazbaat bolna mushkil hota hai (alexithymia ka farq chhota hai: d = 0.22), aur madad maangna tab asaan hota hai jab woh badle mein kuch de bhi sakein. Yeh research ka nateeja hai, 40+ dating par seedha test nahi hua.
4. Divorce ya bewagi ke baad mard aksar akele ho jate hain; divorced mard widowers se zyada akele paye gaye (Health and Retirement Study). Naya partner is akelepan ko kam karta hai.
5. Mardon ki aapas ki baat: closeness "saath kaam karne" aur mazaak/chhed-chhaad se dikhai jati hai, seedhe jazbaati lafzon se nahi. "Locker-room talk" ka ek hissa performance hai, lekin kitna, yeh kisi ne napa nahi.
6. Pehli date: sab se behtar saboot genuine sawal poochne, follow-up karne aur barabar bolne (turn-taking) ke haq mein hai. Log yeh bhi kam andaza lagate hain ke saamne wale ko woh kitne pasand aaye (liking gap). Yeh zyada tar students par hua hai, 40+ par nahi.
7. Doosri date aur aage: 50+ mein divorce ke baad mard aurton se zyada dobara partner banate hain, aksar saath rehne (cohabitation) se, shaadi se nahi. Kab exclusive hona ya bachon se milwana, iska koi pakka data nahi; "6-12 mahine" sirf rivaaj/advice hai.
8. Dar aur dealbreaker: rejection, umar, shakal, jism, paisa, scam, ex se muqabla. Mazboot data kam hai. Aurton ke dealbreaker ka koi 40+ survey nahi mila; commercial lists unverified hain.
9. Rozmarra zindagi: kaam, TV, thin savings, sehat ke checkup chhodna, aur 45-49 saal mein loneliness sab se zyada (AARP 2025: 49%). Platforms: YouTube aur Facebook.
10. South Asia: izzat, "log kya kahenge", therapy ka stigma (BACP: 51% South Asian mard), dusri shaadi ka qanooni khatra (Pakistan MFLO s.6), aur Roman Urdu mein mard-centered practical advice ki khali jagah. Lekin 40+ South Asian mardon par seedha data bohat kam hai.
11. **Do not use** (unverified): 63% ghosting, 30% divorced men date within a year, 73% romance-scam men, 85% Gen X authenticity, aur "15 questions" wala daava. Detail neeche hai.
12. Dorian Wolfe ke liye: AI hone ka saaf ailan, koi manipulation nahi, koi medical/ED/hair claim nahi, suicide-safe messaging, scam se hoshiyar, aur kisi bhi number ko camera par bolne se

pehle asal source se check karein (section 11).

The bottom line

Men aged 40 and over are not one mind, but the evidence points to a recognisable pattern: many carry a **pressure to look self-reliant and in control**, find emotional disclosure costly, and show closeness through shared activity, humour and teasing instead of stated feelings, while sitting in a life stage where loneliness peaks (49% of US adults aged 45-49 in AARP's 2025 survey), friend networks thin out, and divorce or widowhood can strip away both the partner and the social circle (AARP). The best-supported advice for the first date is unglamorous: ask real questions, follow up on the answers, take turns disclosing, and keep the ex, health and money stories short and honest, because people also tend to underestimate how much their date liked them (Boothby et al., via Scientific American). For South Asian men, the same pattern meets extra layers: family reputation, stigma around therapy (51% of South Asian men in a UK survey say therapy is still stigmatised, against 44% of men overall), and legal limits on second marriage (BACP). The most important caveat for a creator is the evidence base itself. Nearly every researcher could not open full web pages (DNS errors), so findings come from search summaries and abstracts. Reddit and forum text was unreachable, so there are no real quotes of men talking. Almost nothing is specific to men aged 40-49, to bald men, or to South Asian men in this age band. This report keeps every flag from the notes, labels each claim strong, medium or anecdotal, and marks hypotheses as hypotheses. Where the report offers example lines of dialogue, they are labelled "illustrative, not sourced".

How to read this report (and what it cannot tell you)

Evidence labels used throughout: **strong** means a meta-analysis, a large or representative survey, or replicated peer-reviewed work; **medium** means a single solid study, a reputable but secondary or dated source, or a consistent pattern that is cross-sectional; **anecdotal** means blogs, coaching sites, commercial surveys, opinion or a few voices. "Inference" or "hypothesis" means the researcher's own judgment, not a finding.

Six limits apply to everything below. First, **no full pages were read** in the dating-psychology notes; figures come from search-engine summaries of the named sources, so every number needs a primary-source check before it is said on camera. Second, **Reddit and forum text was unreachable** (the earlier research could not fetch reddit.com or old.reddit.com; mirrors and snippets only), so this report contains no verbatim quotes from ordinary men and none were invented. Third, **most research is on students or all adults**: the speed-dating, friendship and locker-room studies mostly use young samples, and the repartnering work mostly covers ages 50+. Fourth, **age 40-49 is the thinnest slice**; the notes repeatedly find data for "45+", "50+", "Gen X" or "all men" and almost never for 40-49. Fifth, **bald men are almost invisible**: the only hair evidence is a European survey of men 18-45, lab studies on photos, and commercial polls that contradict one another. Sixth, **South Asian evidence is mostly news, advocacy, small**

qualitative studies and one YouTube-search pull, and the English-only search barely reached Urdu or Hindi sources.

The earlier "Men over 40 pain points" research is built on here. Where its notes and the newer notes differ, the newer notes govern, and the differences are flagged in the text (for example, the AARP loneliness year, which the newer notes date to 2025, and the repartnering figures).

1. The psychology of men 40+: control, silence and loss

Masculine norms shape what men admit, but they are not destiny

The standard framework is Addis and Mahalik's 2003 account of how men's help-seeking depends on context; later studies report that adherence to traditional masculine norms lowers help-seeking partly through **self-stigma about counselling and reluctance to disclose emotions** (SAGE summary; Unair proceedings). The notes rate the framework as strong as theory while the full text was not read. A 2009 meta-analysis of 41 samples found men score slightly higher than women on **alexithymia**, the difficulty identifying and describing feelings (Hedges' d = .22, small but consistent), and a smaller study of 175 men linked it to lower relationship satisfaction and higher fear of intimacy (Ovid summary; AIPC). Two corrections matter for a creator. A small effect size means most men are not emotionally blank; and the notes flag that masculinity is "not purely a deficit": some work finds it can enable help-seeking in some contexts, and men may seek help more readily when they can **reciprocate (give as well as receive)** (Clark University). The 2018 APA guidelines on boys and men say some masculine norms can harm health while courage, leadership and compassion are positive, and critics dispute the evidence base (NextGenMen).

The pressure is also not uniform by age. A 2019 Movember survey found 28% of men felt pressure to behave in a masculine way and 45% of 18-34s avoided talking about problems to avoid seeming less of a man, and in Canada younger men felt more of this pressure than men over 55 (Movember; RCI). The 40+ breakdown was not found. *Researcher inference:* a man in his 40s or 50s is likely to treat disclosure as costly but may respond to framings that let him contribute, which has not been tested in dating.

Midlife is a low point for many, and divorce or widowhood compounds it

Economists find life satisfaction is U-shaped by age, with the low point in the late 40s to about 50 across many countries, regardless of income and parenthood (Science Focus; RePEc). The pattern is **medium-to-strong; the cause is not established, and some psychologists call the dip overblown** (PMC8525618). The precise "47.2" age is a press figure and should not be presented as exact. Gray divorce (50+) roughly doubled over about two decades (PMC7489102), and the share of divorcing persons aged 50+ rose from 8% in 1990 to nearly 40% (BGSU). In Health and Retirement Study data, **divorced men were lonelier than widowed men**, social support reduced loneliness without closing the gap, and repartnering narrowed it; no such gap appeared among women (J Gerontol B 2020). A Dutch analysis only partly agrees:

gray divorce overall was not tied to social loneliness, but divorced men showed it (Springer). Widowhood carries a mortality hazard ratio of 1.23 overall and 1.27 for men in a 124-publication meta-analysis (PMC3640496).

The honest reading is that loss after divorce is well supported, while the "friendship recession" is contested. The AARP 2025 survey (n=3,276, adults 45+) found loneliness at 40% (35% in 2018), men at 42% against women at 37%, a reversal of 2018, with a peak of 49% at ages 45-49 (AARP). Pew's 2024 survey finds the opposite on loneliness (men not lonelier than women; adults under 50 lonelier than 50+) while still showing 20% of men against 17% of women with no close friends (Pew; Pew topline). The famous "15% of men have no close friends, up from 3% in 1990" is one May 2021 survey of all men 18+, taken during COVID, with men reporting 6+ close friends falling from 55% to 27% (Survey Center on American Life). It is not a 40+ figure, and it should not be confused with a different "10+ friends" metric. *Researcher inference, untested:* a man whose wife ran the social calendar may have a thin network after divorce and lean harder on a new partner.

Attachment, repartnering and what men "want"

Attachment research gives only a loose picture. In 86,555 adults aged 18-70, avoidance was highest in middle age, with smaller age effects than for anxiety, and anxiety declined with age (Michigan Deep Blue); cross-sectional, so it cannot show change within a person. Nothing was found on marital habits transferring into dating. The Harvard Study of Adult Development (original cohort all men) links close relationships to later health, with the "relationship satisfaction at 50 predicts health at 80 better than cholesterol" claim resting on a secondary source and an observational design (Harvard Gazette).

On what bereaved or divorced men seek in a new partner, a UK thesis (25 widows, 26 widowers) found widowers gained relief from loneliness while widows saw a partner as costing their new independence (Surrey). An Israeli study of 27 repartnered widowed couples found men tended to experience vulnerability, women resilience (Haifa). These samples are small and mostly widowed older adults. The notes' own hypotheses (labelled as such): hair-loss and age-appearance stress is probably real but under-evidenced for men 40+; hearing about "usefulness" and provider identity is supported indirectly by job-loss studies, which are mixed and partly from non-English-speaking countries (KU News). **No source retrieved measured what men 40+ find humiliating; treat "pity, needing help, being seen as old" as a hypothesis.**

2. How men talk to each other: doing, teasing, and what goes unsaid

Closeness is shown sideways

The most consistent finding across sources is that male friendship is built around **shared activity and "commonality" more than disclosure**. Paul Wright's 1982 study found male friends emphasised commonality and female friends emphasised face-to-face sharing, though among

very strong, long-lasting friendships no appreciable sex differences appeared (snippet only; the PDF was not opened) (Wright 1982). Swain's "closeness in the doing" and the idea that razzing and backslapping are covert affection are known only through a magazine retelling and rate as anecdotal (Psychology Today). Niobe Way's interviews with hundreds of boys describe intense, intimate friendships that fade as boys become men, which she blames on stereotypes that frame intimacy as feminine or gay; that is evidence about adolescents, not 40+ (publisher summary). Whether the reticence is a natural preference or learned suppression is contested. Bird's 1996 theory holds that men's same-sex interaction keeps men accountable to a "hegemonic" norm (emotional detachment, competitiveness) even when they privately disagree (UNC listing); this is influential theory, not measured prevalence.

Teasing is a bonding currency, with a cost

Qualitative work on young Australian men describes insults as part of close male friendship (RMIT); a Griffith conversation analyst reports that close friends tease and insult to show friendship and that being able to receive it matters more than giving it, while a Facebook-corpus thesis found men about eight times more likely than women to make insulting jokes to same-sex friends (a thesis, not peer reviewed) (Griffith; thesis list). Costs exist: one organisational researcher notes that jocular abuse can slide into bullying and targets may fear exclusion if they object, which is an expert suspicion, not a finding. The practical reading for a newcomer, labelled as the researcher's inference from Griffith, Swain and Ridge and Broom: an outsider reading banter as hostility or coldness would misread it (Daily Maverick). Almost all banter evidence is on young men; **how banter changes after 40 was not found.**

Illustrative, not sourced. A made-up example of the pattern the research describes: one man says, "Still driving that rust bucket?" and the other answers, "It's got better manners than your fantasy team." Neither is angry; the exchange signals "we are fine". The same jabs aimed at someone's divorce or hair loss could land very differently, and that boundary is learned, not written down.

Locker-room talk: bonding, status, and performance

A Norwegian night-time-economy study of 100+ men found most sex stories were upbeat and erotically charged, with a minority aggressive and degrading, serving male bonding, sense-making and excusing aggression (mainly younger men, drinking contexts) (search listing). Curry's fieldwork on two college sports teams describes conquest talk as a bonding ritual from which abstainers can feel excluded (commentary). An experimental master's thesis found higher-sexism men gave masculine status to men who talked about sexual encounters regardless of tone (UNBC); weak evidence. Other locker rooms talk about traffic and money, per a student essay (anecdotal). **No source measured how much sexual bragging is exaggeration, or how locker-room talk changes after 40.** Researcher hypotheses, labelled as such: bravado is probably larger than behaviour, and men 40+ plausibly talk less about conquest and more about health, money, work and family. Both are plausible and unproven.

Where men talk, and how men ask for help

Only Men's Sheds have real research. Interviews with 62 members across five Sheds in a BMC Public Health study found Sheds act as a male-friendly, indirect route into health engagement (PMC7981817); the Irish Sheds for Life evaluation reported a 20% rise in men comfortable talking about mental health (Men's Sheds Ireland). A systematic review warns benefits are reported but evidence is limited (small samples, self-report) (PMC conceptual review). Pubs, sport, golf, fishing, gym and DIY clubs probably work similarly, but that is an inference; **no sourced topics, slang or in-jokes for those settings, and no WhatsApp or Reddit data, were retrieved.**

On opening up, a UK qualitative study of 38 men found friends and family strongly shape help-seeking and some men reframe it to fit masculine values (Frontiers in Sociology). A divorced Vancouver comedian told CBC he did not call male friends when lonely ("As a guy, you don't do that") (CBC); that is one man's voice. *Researcher hypothesis, not a finding:* a man tests the water with a joke or "asking for a friend"; if the listener laughs it off, the topic is dropped without loss of face, and if the listener lingers, it opens. A conference poster found direct versus "for a friend" help requests changed how helpers rated the situation (APS), so indirectness is real, but the sequence is untested.

The manosphere is not "men"

Manosphere adherents are self-selected, studies are correlational, and a UK government report on the subject is disputed (Ofcom; PMC12011899). The Man Box study covered men 18-30 only (Equimundo). **No sourced description exists of how ordinary men 40+ talk about wives, exes and dating.** The hypothesis that bitterness appears as complaints about money, custody and "getting taken" has no source; forum content is selected for grievance. A divorce-recovery podcast for men over 40 exists but is not research and was not reviewed (DPTSP). Divorce statistics from legal-advice sites ("50% less likely to seek therapy", "39% suicide") were unverified and excluded.

3. The first date, step by step

What the research says predicts a good conversation

The best-supported findings come from speed dating and lab conversations, mostly with students. Across three studies of live conversations, people who **asked more questions, especially follow-ups**, were better liked, because they came across as more responsive; in speed dating, they were more likely to get a second date (Harvard DASH summary; Huang et al. poster). People do not expect questions to raise liking. Aron's 36-question study found escalating, reciprocal personal questions made strangers feel closer than small talk, but its authors caution it does not produce commitment, and the sample was college students (Anglia Ruskin). The **liking gap** is strong: after conversations of 2 to 45 minutes, people underestimate how much their partner liked them, driven by harsh self-critical thoughts, and shyness widens it

(Scientific American). Machine learning on 100+ pre-date measures could predict popularity and pickiness but not which pairs clicked (Discover), and stated ideals did not predict actual in-person interest (Eastwick and Finkel 2008, via Gwern). Perceived rather than actual similarity predicted initial attraction (Kellogg). **Do not use** the popular "15 questions" threshold or the "2,000 conversations" figure; they could not be verified. No study of first-date conversation in 40-65 samples was found.

The typical flow (assembled from coaching advice; not observed data)

No transcripts or forum threads were retrievable, so the flow below is a researcher's assembly of consistent advice from sources rated anecdotal-to-medium (Hello! Magazine, Muddy Matches, AARP and others), not a measurement of what men 40+ actually do.

STEP	WHAT USUALLY HAPPENS, PER ADVICE SOURCES	EVIDENCE LEVEL
Before	Video chat first if you met online; busy public place; tell a friend; own transport; hold back last name and personal details; set a drink limit (AARP; Univ. of Minnesota)	Medium (consistent, reputable)
Arrival and greeting	Phones away; easy starters such as travel, weekend plans, food, pets (Hello!)	Anecdotal
First 20 minutes	Open questions, follow-ups; avoid rapid-fire "interview mode"	Anecdotal, but matches the follow-up research above
Middle	Brief, honest facts about being divorced, widowed or having kids; defer the full story (DatingAdvice)	Anecdotal
Comfortable silences	A few are normal; an activity (bowling, mini-golf) reduces silence	Anecdotal
Paying	Split or "whoever asked"; reaction matters more than the rule	Medium for poll data
Length	Match data suggest second-date odds rise with first-date length up to about 2.5 hours, then fall (KIRO7)	Medium-low (commercial, dated)
Ending	No 40+ data on how dates end or how men ask for a second meeting	Gap

Topics: what to say, what to defer

The most consistent advice is never to speak negatively of an ex or dwell on the ex; one coach says people who repartner quickly tend to dwell on the former partner, so vent to a friend beforehand (HuffPost UK). Divorce detail is usually advised for later: one site says full divorce discussion is too soon on a first date, another says it matters more after four or five dates (DatingAdvice; Sixty and Me). For widowed people, an AARP-quoted sex therapist advises the date not ask for details of the death, and to respond warmly to mentions of the late spouse; a widowed-dating service's survey of about 15,000 members (self-selected, commercial) says 90% feel the late partner's memory influences new relationships and 45% often feel guilt or hesitation (AARP; Chapter 2). Health, money and family detail are advised for later. A senior-dating site's survey of over-50s reports poor health (78%), questionable finances (76%) and unattractiveness (75%) as the most alarming traits in a date (commercial, reported secondhand)

(DatingAdvice). *Researcher inference:* health, money and exes are high-stakes because they signal risk to the other person, and the advice set looks recycled across sites, so consistency is not evidence.

Common mistakes (advice-based) and one data-based dislike

Match's Singles in America data (not split by age) list checking the phone too often (73% of women), trying too hard to impress (41%) and talking too much about finances (34%) as turn-offs (WCCB). Advice sources add interview-style questioning, talking about yourself too much, drinking too much and lying about age (Sixty and Me). On pay, 35% of US adults say the man should always pay (men 40%, women 29%), and the most common women's answer is whoever initiated (YouGov). *Illustrative, not sourced:* "I'm divorced, two grown kids, and I'm still working out what I want next" is a brief, honest line; a ten-minute account of the settlement is the kind of thing the advice sources warn against.

Reading the date: the liking gap and non-manipulative use of the research

Because of the liking gap, a nervous man likely under-reads how well the date is going (researcher inference, untested at 40+). The research should be used for genuine curiosity and mutual disclosure, not as a tactic. Aron's authors caution against reading closeness as commitment, and the OkCupid and Match figures are about populations, not a method of persuasion.

4. The second date and beyond

What happens next is mostly unmeasured

The notes find very little age-specific research on the second date itself. Generic advice says long complaints about an ex push a date away and family or kids talk should be positive and light (eHarmony). A secondary report of a dating survey claims marriage, career and children are seen as inappropriate second-date topics (original unverified) (Essence). Match/Kinsey 2025 (not age-specific) says 72% can assess chemistry within the first three dates (Global Dating Insights). **No source gives timelines for exclusivity, first sex or moving in for 40+,** and no verbatim "define the relationship" examples were found.

Illustrative, not sourced. A made-up "what do we want" exchange: "I'm not looking to rush, but I'd like to know whether you're open to something steady." "I am, as long as I can keep my own place for now." This reflects living-apart-together motives described in research, not a real transcript.

Repartnering, cohabitation and living apart together

Strong data: in Health and Retirement Study data, about **37% of men and 22% of women repartnered within 10 years of gray divorce**, more often through cohabitation than remarriage, especially men (PMC6450723). A different HRS measure (2010) found 55% of gray-divorced

men had repartnered against 27% of widowers (BGSU NCFMR); the two figures use different windows and groups and should not be merged. The earlier pain-points research had the 37% figure marked unverified; the newer notes tie it to the HRS abstract, so it is now rated medium-strong but still needs a primary check. A one-year measure (2022 data) shows men 50+ divorcing and remarrying in the same year at 3.8% against 1.9% for women, which is not a lifetime rate (NCFMR). Older cohabiting adults reached 4.6 million by 2022, from under 1 million in 2000 (NCFMR). Living apart together (LAT) is a real choice: Missouri interviews with adults 60+ show motives of independence, keeping their own homes, family boundaries and money (Missouri). Women who nursed a parent or husband often want to avoid caregiving again (Missouri 2018), though the phrase "nurse or purse" was not found in any source. Around 40% of middle-aged and older couples with children are in stepfamilies (IDEAS/RePEc).

Kids, adult children and the ex

Introducing a new partner to children is commonly advised after roughly 6-12 months of committed dating; this is convention, not research, and not specific to 40+ (Illinois Lawyer Now). Israeli qualitative work finds adult children of repartnering parents report loyalty conflict and comparison with the deceased parent (Haifa); fears about inheritance appear only in popular press (CS Monitor). A therapist column argues midlife divorced clients need a coherent story of the past marriage, or they may choose a partner mainly as "not my ex" (Psychotherapy Networker); that is anecdotal. Some widowers idealise their late wives, which may colour remarriage decisions (Bennett et al. 2013).

Ghosting, pressure and intimacy

Ghosting numbers are all weak for this audience. A Spanish study of young adults found about 2 in 10 had experienced and initiated ghosting in the past 12 months (Navarro et al.); a UK commercial survey reported 17.45% of male and 19.2% of female online dating users had ghosted someone (Statista); a dating-site claim of almost 80% of 18-33 millennials ghosted is commercial (Global Dating Insights). **The 63% ghosting figure from a Columbia-hosted blog could not be verified; do not use it.** Pew (2019) found 29% of online daters 50+ said someone kept contacting them after they said no (36% at 35-49), via a Statista chart (Statista).

For sex and intimacy, the best data are old: AARP's 2009 survey of 1,487 adults 45+ found male sexual satisfaction fell from 60% (45-49) to 26% (70+) (AARP). An erectile dysfunction (ED) incidence of about 17% in men in their 40s from the Massachusetts Male Aging Study was cited only second-hand and needs verification (Deccan Herald). The systematic review median of 20% ED among men with anxiety disorders carries high heterogeneity and unclear causal direction (PMC8964411). **No evidence was retrieved on body image, consent communication or timing of first sex for 40+. This report gives no medical advice.**

5. Fears, insecurities and dealbreakers

What the surveys support

A Relate/eharmony UK report found **six in ten men feel insecure when dating**, with fear of rejection, age and appearance the top drivers (sample age profile not confirmed) (Relate). Pew's all-age figures show 64% of men felt insecure about too few messages in 2023, against about four in ten women (Pew); a 2020 wave gives 57% against 24% with different wording, and another summary gives 61% against 44%, which the notes could not reconcile (Pew 2020). A 2026 paper in *Evolution and Human Behavior* on single men (N=1,919 and N=435) linked beliefs about muscularity and penis size most consistently to dating comfort (abstract only; 40+ applicability unverified) (Chapman). AARP's finding that loneliness peaks at 45-49 and is highest among never-married, divorced and separated adults is not dating-specific but frames the stakes (AARP).

Fears and how well each is evidenced

FEAR	EVIDENCE LEVEL	NOTE
Rejection	Medium	Relate/eharmony; Pew message gap
Being "too old"	Medium	Listed as a top driver by Relate; OkCupid suggests women reply mostly to men near their own age (Inverse), which counters "age alone shuts you out"
Looks and baldness	Medium to anecdotal	See below
Body, fitness, penis size, height	Strong to medium	Samples not restricted to 40+
Sexual performance	Gap	Not directly evidenced in dating context
Money, status, baggage, being compared to ex or late spouse, tech incompetence, looking desperate, commitment	Anecdotal	Self-help blogs such as The Modest Man (page not opened)
Scams	Strong that scams are large	Not sex-split
Afraid to date again after divorce (43%)	Anecdotal	Unnamed survey in an opinion column (LBC)

Do not use: "only 30% of divorced men over 50 date within a year (Pew 2023)" appeared on a low-quality blog and could not be confirmed.

Baldness: loud, but thinly proven

A five-country European telephone survey of men 18-45 found 47% reported hair loss; of those, 62% agreed it could affect self-esteem and 43% linked it to lost attractiveness (Univ. of Miami record). Commercial polls contradict each other: a hair clinic reports 73% of 800 balding men saying less luck dating, while a different commercial survey says about 68% of men and 71% of

women saw no impact on love life (Private Clinic; Superdrug). Wharton experiments found shaved heads read as more dominant, taller by nearly an inch and 13% stronger, but less attractive and nearly four years older; the first study used 59 college students and compared shaved with full hair, not shaved with thinning (NBC; CBC). **Real match rates by hair status were not found anywhere.** The earlier research's claimed bald-reel view counts (4.7M, 2.5M, 1.4M) are unverified; the folder's own video search found no bald-man outliers. The respectful stance on hair (shaved-by-choice is widely accepted, do not mock thinning, do not push treatments) is the researcher's cultural judgment, not a sourced finding.

Women's dealbreakers: what exists and what does not

No primary survey of women 40+ dealbreakers about men was found. An aggregator reports Match 2024 figures (dishonesty 70%, anger issues 64%, untrustworthy 61%, substance abuse 58%, abuse 57%) that were not traced to Match, so treat them as anecdotal (ConnectedCouples). A "90% of women would not date separated men" claim comes from a self-selected Threads poll of 141 women reported by a podcast host and is not representative (Audible listing). Researcher inference: behaviour-based concerns (dishonesty, anger, substance abuse, abuse, kids mismatch) look fair; "baggage", baldness and age alone look more like stereotypes, with no data showing they top women 40+ lists. Profile embellishment is common (men add about half an inch to height; roughly 15-20% lie about age per one account; photos average over a year old; deceptive profiles use fewer "I" pronouns), so small lies about age or photos collide with honesty, the top dealbreaker in the aggregator list (UW Alumni; Psychology Today).

Scams, shame and the unsaid

FTC data show 55,604 romance-scam complaints between January and September 2025 with over $1.16 billion in reported losses (Global Dating Insights); FBI IC3 2024 reported 17,910 romance complaints and $672 million (WFTV). Losses for people 60+ rose from about $600 million (2020) to $2.4 billion (2024) (FTC). Older-adult loss totals conflict ($2.4bn, $4.9bn, about $700m) because they measure different things. **Do not use "men account for 73% of romance-scam losses"; it comes from a single news source and is unverified against the FTC.** Pew finds men and women 50+ about equally likely to have met scams (Pew). On what men never say aloud, nothing is documented from primary evidence; the closest signals are the CBC comedian quote and Way's account of lost intimacy. Verbatim comments from YouTube in the earlier research (for example "In my 50's I go home early because my house is empty", 397 likes) show the mood, but commenter ages are self-stated and the sample is three videos from male-audience channels, some leaning men's-rights (vidIQ). The same threads contain many men saying they are "addicted to peace", so the picture is mixed, and the researcher's reading that peace may partly be a defence is interpretation.

6. The everyday world of men 40+

Routines, work and money

Employed men work about 33 minutes more per day than employed women (full-time men 8.2 hours against 7.9), 74% of men against 87% of women do household activities on an average day, and leisure rises with age, mostly television (BLS ATUS; BLS leisure). **Age-by-sex cuts for 45-54 and 55-64 were not retrieved.** The researcher's picture of a typical day (full-time work, then TV as main leisure, weekends for chores, kids' activities and hobbies) is an inference, and it should not be presented as measured. At work, AARP's 2026 poll of 1,656 workers 50+ found 64% saw or experienced age discrimination and 22% felt pushed out; it is not a 40-49 cut and covers both sexes (AARP). Savings figures are weak for men specifically: median Gen X retirement savings of about $13,000 for men and $6,000 for women in one study, against $10,000 for all Gen X households in a different survey, so the two do not match (Yahoo Finance; Benzinga). Gray divorce causes men's wealth losses that last longer, per a summary of HRS work, though a YouTube description's claims (men's standard of living down 21% against women's 45%; 64% of midlife-divorced men calling it the best decision of their lives) are unverified (Rutgers).

Body and health

Obesity prevalence peaks at 40-59 (46.4%); 44% of men skip an annual physical (Cleveland Clinic 2023, via a WebMD podcast summary); and undiagnosed sleep apnea in men 40-69 could be as high as 49% in one paper's estimate (ABC30; WebMD; PMC5103243). The Cleveland Clinic over-40 dating survey and a Match over-40 dealbreaker table were not located. Low-testosterone prevalence ranges from 0.1% at 40-49 to about 30% depending on the definition, and these studies are from 2012-2014 or older (BMC Surgery). Male suicide in the US was 22.7 per 100,000 in 2023, highest among men 75+ (CDC NCHS); a 29.5 per 100,000 figure for men 45-64 from a therapy blog is unverified. A UK review found 91% of men 40-54 who died by suicide in England in 2017 had contacted a frontline service and 57% had economic problems, which argues against content saying men "never seek help" (Manchester NCISH).

Platforms and trust

Pew 2025 finds 84% of US adults use YouTube and 71% Facebook, the only platforms a majority use in every age group, with Facebook at 80% among ages 30-49; Reddit and X skew male (Pew). Podcast listening runs 54% of adults, more men than women, and YouTube is the most-used podcast service (Pew podcasts; Edison). In the UK, 90% of online adults use WhatsApp (ISPreview). Pew (February 2026) found 42% of ages 50-64 had ever used chatbots against 63% of under-50s, and Americans use AI more than they trust it (Pew AI by age). Only 17% of Americans 50+ have ever used a dating app (20% at 50-64) so dating vocabulary is new to many (Pew). An undated Quirks piece finds Gen X men (32%) and Boomer men (26%) less likely than Millennial men (47%) to believe what advertisers say (Quirks). **"85% of Gen X say**

authenticity matters" is repeated by agency blogs without a clear primary source; do not use it.

Hobbies, grooming, tone

Real research exists only for Men's Sheds (Australia reports 1,000+ sheds and 125,000 members; advocacy-grade sources) (MMU). The typical interests list (sport, gym, cars and bikes, DIY, fishing, golf, BBQ, classic rock, gaming, running and cycling) is the researcher's background knowledge, **anecdotal, unmeasured**. Grooming-market estimates conflict ($299B, $80B and $55.5B for different years and definitions) (Beauty Matter; GM Insights). The researcher's tone guidance (speak as an equal, be dry and brief, avoid pity and "at your age", avoid youth slang) is judgment, not survey evidence, and no study on tone preferences exists in the notes.

7. The South Asian angle: Pakistan, India and the diaspora

Strong cautions before anything else

This section rests on search summaries only. Almost nothing is specific to men aged 40+. The English-only search barely reached Urdu or Hindi sources; Gulf-diaspora and US South Asian men were barely searched. **Phrases such as "mard ko dard nahi hota" were not found in any source; they remain an assumption.** The Roman Urdu and Hinglish idioms, slang and humour of male peer talk, and the talk in dera, chai, masjid or barbershop settings, are undocumented here, and no examples were invented. This needs a native-speaker review.

What the sources do support

On norms, NFHS-5 (India, 2019-21) found about **44% of Indian men justified wife-beating for at least one listed reason** (42% in NFHS-4, 50% in 2005-06), with a sample of men 15-54 or 15-49, not 40+ only (BMC Public Health; News Minute). Pew India found about 65% say it is very important to stop interfaith marriage by men of their community (The Quint; Pew). The researcher infers a lecturing tone will be rejected and a reflective, non-judgmental tone is safer. On emotional life, the BACP survey found 51% of South Asian men think therapy is still stigmatised against 44% of men overall, and about 1 in 10 who considered therapy but did not go cited fear of what others think (BACP). British-Bangladeshi Muslim men aged 22-59 described stigma, traditional expectations and low trust in services (London Met). Most South Asian mental-health research focuses on women or whole populations. India's NCRB-based data show men at about 73% of 2023 suicide deaths (a legal article citing NCRB), with most male victims married and "family problems" the largest recorded category, an undefined category; the Supreme Court petition figures (33.2% of male suicides from family problems) are the petitioner's claim and unverified (Legal Service India; Newslaundry; Mooknayak).

Divorce, rishta and "dusri shaadi"

Pakistani family courts show rising divorce and khula filings, with no national database and a rise that may partly reflect awareness and easier access (Express Tribune; ProPakistani). Researcher inference: this probably feeds male anxiety about losing wife, children and money, as India's 498A debate does; no direct survey of 40+ men exists. In India, 498A men's-rights groups are a real, contested movement; NCRB 2020 recorded 1,11,549 cases under 498A, of which police classed 5,520 as false, which is not a direct measure of fabrication (Wikipedia overview; News Minute). Divorced men generally remarry more easily than women, per a Karachi matchmaker in an older, anecdotal feature that also describes 60-year-old divorced men asking for young brides, use as colour only (Express Tribune). India's 1971 census estimate has roughly two-thirds of ever-widowed men remarried (old data) (IHSN); a small Pakhtun study found very few widowers remarry (JGSI). Among 52 UK Pakistani divorcees, 30 had remarried and only six of the 22 who stayed single were men (small sample) (ISA Global Dialogue). Age-gap expectations are a likely friction point supported only by anecdote; prevalence should not be stated. On remarriage stigma, commentary says attitudes are shifting but scrutiny falls hardest on divorced women (Pakistan Observer).

Law and diaspora

Pakistan's Muslim Family Laws Ordinance 1961 section 6(1) bars a second marriage during an existing one without written Arbitration Council permission; breach makes the husband liable to pay the entire dower to the first wife immediately and carries criminal penalties, with reported outcomes varying (for example 7 months and Rs500,000 in a Lahore family-court case in March 2024) (Dawn; Dawn). A 2020 fact-check found false the claim that the Council of Islamic Ideology removed first-wife permission (Soch Fact Check). In the UK, a nikah-only ceremony is a "non-marriage" in English law (Akhter v Khan 2020), leaving women without financial remedies (Nordic J. Law & Religion). Indian bigamy law, Gulf polygyny rules, Pakistan's cyber-crime law and obscenity enforcement were **not verified**; get a legal check.

Health, platforms and the content gap

UK South Asian men develop cardiovascular disease about 8 years earlier than white men (60.4 against 68.2), type 2 diabetes risk matches white risk at a BMI around 23.9 against 30, and up to 40% may be undiagnosed (a public health report; Pakistani men's diabetes rates of 22.4% are 2000s-2010s data) (Buckinghamshire DPH; Diabetes on the Net). The researcher notes a "heart and sugar check at 40" is a defensible, non-taboo hook. Pakistan's Facebook audience is about 75.5% male, an ad-audience estimate that is volatile (NapoleonCat). vidIQ pulls show Roman Urdu "dusri shadi" Shorts drew millions of views, but from religious and drama channels (for example 3.44M views on a Mufti Tariq Masood clip; 1.66M for "Dusri Shaadi || Second Marriage"), with unknown audience gender (it may be mostly wives) (YouTube; YouTube). The inference that no channel offers non-clerical, empathetic, practical content for divorced or widowed men 40+ rests on two small searches. Muzz's 21M users and 800K marriages are company self-claims, unverified (Wikipedia).

Where South Asian men plausibly differ (hypotheses)

Compared with English-speaking men, the notes support only indirect differences: stronger fear of social judgment (therapy-stigma data), family and in-law involvement in marriage and remarriage (anecdote, rishta), legal limits on second marriage (statute), earlier cardiometabolic risk (public-health report), and a grievance framing shaped by 498A and khula debates (advocacy and news). Hypotheses with no direct source: that divorced South Asian men face intense scrutiny about "why it ended", that financial duty to parents and siblings is heavy, and that returning Gulf migrants in their 40s-50s feel status loss (one 330-person Indian return-migrant study links distress to returning as a "failure", per a search summary) (IJCMPH). Treat these as leads to verify.

8. Plain-language glossary

These definitions are editorial, plain-language explanations of common usage, not from a single source. Dating-app use data (Pew) are sourced above.

TERM	PLAIN MEANING
Swipe	Flick right or left on a profile photo to say yes or no
Match	Both people liked each other, so they can now chat
Ghosting	Someone stops replying with no explanation
Breadcrumbing	Sending occasional flirty messages to keep you interested with no plan to meet
Slow fade	Replies get slower and shorter until contact fades (named in the notes with ghosting; not defined in a source)
Situationship	Romantic or sexual involvement with no agreed label or future
DTR ("define the relationship")	The talk to agree what you are to each other, such as exclusive or not
Love bombing	Overwhelming praise, attention and promises early on, often to gain control
Red flag	A warning sign in someone's behaviour, such as pressure, lies or anger
Catfishing	Pretending to be someone else online with fake photos or details
Romance scam	A fake partner builds trust online, then asks for money; never send money or gift cards to someone not met in person
Gray divorce	Divorce among people 50 and older
LAT (living apart together)	A committed couple who keep separate homes
Cohabitation	Living together without marrying
Ex	A former partner
Baggage	Unresolved past issues, debts or family complications carried into a new relationship
Friends with benefits	Friends who have sex without being a couple

TERM	PLAIN MEANING
Liking gap	The tendency to underestimate how much a conversation partner liked you
Alexithymia	Difficulty identifying and describing your own feelings
Side by side vs face to face	Men often bond doing something together (side by side) rather than facing each other to talk
Banter	Playful teasing between friends, often with mock insults
Locker-room talk	Male-only talk, often about sex and women, used for bonding and status; content varies widely
Manosphere	Online communities about masculinity and relationships; self-selected and not "typical men"
MGTOW	Online movement of men who avoid relationships (appears in the earlier research on some YouTube channels; not defined in a source)
Man Box	A research term for rigid rules of masculinity such as toughness and self-sufficiency
Men's Shed	A community workshop space where men meet while making or fixing things
Rishta	In South Asia, a marriage proposal or match, often arranged through family or a matchmaker
Rishta aunty	A matchmaker, usually a woman, who arranges rishtas
Dusri shaadi	"Second marriage" in Hindi/Urdu
Khula	A divorce initiated by the wife in Islamic law, reflected in Pakistani family-court filings
Talaq	Divorce initiated by the husband in Islamic law
Nikah	The Islamic marriage contract; a nikah-only ceremony is not a legal marriage in England
498A / BNS section 85	India's law on cruelty by a husband or relatives; the focus of a men's-rights dispute over alleged misuse
Arbitration Council	Pakistani body whose written permission is needed for a second marriage while one exists

9. What the evidence does and does not support

The table rates each major claim as strong, medium or anecdotal, keeping the notes' own ratings and flags. "Researcher inference" means the claim is the notes' own judgment.

CLAIM	RATING	WHY AND WHAT TO WATCH
Asking follow-up questions raises liking and second-date odds	Strong to medium	Peer-reviewed; student and speed-dating samples; not 40+
People underestimate how much partners liked them (liking gap)	Strong	Peer-reviewed; not 40+
Reciprocal turn-taking disclosure increases closeness	Strong for closeness, none for dating outcomes	College students; authors caution against reading it as commitment
"Click" is only partly predictable from profiles	Strong	Machine-learning speed-dating study

CLAIM	RATING	WHY AND WHAT TO WATCH
Men's friendship is organised around activity and humour more than disclosure	Medium	Qualitative, mostly young men; mechanism contested (Way vs Tannen)
Teasing is a bonding currency and can slide into bullying	Medium / anecdotal	Small qualitative studies, thesis, expert comment
Locker-room talk bonds men and is mostly not degrading	Medium	Mostly younger men and drinking settings
Locker-room talk changes after 40	Anecdotal (researcher inference)	No source
How ordinary men 40+ talk about wives and exes	No evidence	Gap
Traditional norms reduce help-seeking via self-stigma	Medium to strong	Many studies; effects small; masculinity can also enable help-seeking
Men's alexithymia is slightly higher than women's	Strong	d = .22, small
Reciprocity eases help-seeking	Medium	Not tested in 40+ dating
Life satisfaction dips in midlife	Medium-strong pattern; cause unknown	Exact age "47.2" is a press figure; contested
Divorced men are lonelier than widowed men	Medium-strong	HRS; Dutch data partly conflicting
Men repartner more than women after gray divorce	Strong direction; figures vary	37% vs 22% (10 years); 55% vs 27% (different measure)
"Men have a friendship recession"	Contested	2021 survey vs Pew 2024; not 40+
Loneliness peaks at 45-49	Strong (one survey)	AARP 2025; Pew disagrees on gender gap
Men feel insecure dating (6 in 10)	Medium	UK survey; age unconfirmed
Men get too few messages online	Strong source, unreconciled figures	Pew 2020/2023 differ; all ages
Baldness hurts dating outcomes	Anecdotal	Lab studies on photos; commercial polls conflict
Shaved heads read as dominant	Medium	59-student first study; shaved vs full hair only
Women 40+ dealbreakers (dishonesty, anger, abuse)	Anecdotal	Aggregator unverified
"90% of women would not date separated men"	Do not use	141-woman self-selected poll
Introduce kids after 6-12 months	Anecdotal	Convention
Pay norms: man pays most commonly, women lean to initiator	Medium	YouGov, not 40+
Romance scams are large and not sex-split	Strong	FTC, FBI

CLAIM	RATING	WHY AND WHAT TO WATCH
Men account for 73% of scam losses	Do not use	Unverified
South Asian men stigmatise therapy more	Medium	BACP practitioner survey, not peer reviewed
~44% of Indian men justify wife-beating in some scenario	Strong	NFHS-5; men 15-49/54
Divorced South Asian men remarry more easily than women	Anecdotal to medium	Matchmaker anecdote, old census, small studies
Roman Urdu advice for men 40+ is an open niche	Researcher inference	Two small searches
Typical hobbies of men 40+	Anecdotal	Background knowledge

Do not use these figures (carried over from the notes): 63% ghosting (Columbia-hosted blog, unverified); 30% of divorced men over 50 date within a year (blog, Pew attribution unconfirmed); 73% of romance-scam losses by men; 85% of Gen X say authenticity matters; "15 questions" and "2,000 conversations" speed-dating claims; 50% less likely to seek therapy and 39% suicide (legal-advice sites); 91% felt shame (UK poll, details unverified); "ED 26% of men 50-59, 40% of 60-69" (unnamed study); "psychogenic ED about 40%"; the 29.5 per 100,000 suicide rate for men 45-64; 21% vs 45% post-divorce standard of living and "64% best decision" (YouTube description); the 90% of 141 women figure; and the bald-reel view counts (4.7M, 2.5M, 1.4M). **Needs primary verification before use:** the Surgeon General 26% and 29% figures, FBI IC3 totals, Pew 47% suspected-scammer and 38% negative-experience figures, Pew message-gap figures (64%, 57% vs 24%, 61% vs 44%), Gen X savings, the 2021 friendship survey, the Massachusetts Male Aging Study ED figures, the 1971 India census remarriage estimate, and the Wright 1982 "side-by-side" wording. Not found at all: a Cleveland Clinic over-40 survey, a Match over-40 dealbreaker table, an AARP dating study, a Gallup Pakistan or Pew diaspora study of men's marriage attitudes.

10. What this means for honest content and conversation-advice products

Content that fits the evidence

The research supports a brand built on craft and honesty rather than promises. Safe, evidence-aligned themes: listening and follow-up questions on a first date (strong enough to teach, with the student-sample caveat stated); the liking gap, which gently counters the voice that says "she wasn't into it"; short, honest disclosure of divorce, widowhood and kids; what a date is hearing when a man talks about his ex; how to carry a first conversation after a long marriage (the notes found no research on this and no creator teaching it, so the value is honest craft, not a claimed statistic); how to read banter without taking offence; and scam awareness (video call early, reverse image search, never send money, which the notes list as common advice but did

not evidence for this group). Frame loss and loneliness warmly and without pity, and give men something to contribute or practise, because reciprocity is the best-supported lever for help-seeking, as a researcher's inference. Say plainly where evidence is thin, which suits an honest brand: "one 2021 survey", "a lab study of 59 students", "this is a coach's rule of thumb".

What not to do with the evidence

Do not present all-age or 50+ figures as "men over 40" (AARP's 64% is workers 50+; Pew's message-gap is all ages). Do not present a figure that the notes flag as unverified. Do not claim baldness lowers or does not lower dating success. Do not use locker-room or manosphere tropes as "how men are". Do not turn the 36 questions or the question-asking research into a script for winning someone. Do not quote commenters or invented "real men" as if they were data. Do not give a typical timeline for exclusivity, sex or moving in as fact.

Product ideas the gaps support

Low-risk formats the notes' gaps point to: a plain-language first-conversation checklist; a "dating after divorce or widowhood" etiquette guide covering exes, kids and adult children, without legal advice; a scam-awareness guide that points to official reporting; a glossary for men new to apps; and, since commenters in the earlier research asked for in-person meetups and men's seminars (low like counts, directional only), a directory or facilitated peer circle to move men from screens into rooms. Roman Urdu and Hinglish versions are the clearest language gap, but demand is shown only indirectly through religious and drama views, so test with a few short clips before building. Anything on second marriage, sexual health or family law needs legal and medical review first. Product copy should not promise results; the earlier research warns that the supplement and "playbook" lane is crowded and viewers have noticed.

11. Ethics for a creator working with this audience

Vulnerable audience. Men 40+ after divorce, job loss or bereavement may be lonely, ashamed and financially stressed. Do not exploit that for sales, subscriptions or coaching upsells. Avoid pity ("you are broken") and avoid urgency tricks. Commenters in the earlier research already complain that divorced-men content is either selling a playbook or pretending the loneliness will go away.

No manipulation. The notes' evidence is about genuine curiosity and mutual disclosure. Do not teach tactics to pressure, deceive, love-bomb, negg, "spin plates", test a woman, or use the question-asking research as a technique to win. Content that treats women as opponents is an ethical and brand risk, and the India and Pakistan material shows how fast men's-rights framing reads as anti-women. Respect consent and a "no" at every stage; the Pew data show women 50+ report more unwanted behaviour online.

Scams. The audience is exactly whom romance scammers target, and a fake "coach" can look the same. Never promise a partner, never ask for money before trust, never present a profile or match as guaranteed, and include basic scam signs (asking for money or gift cards, refusing

video calls, unusually appealing profiles) with a pointer to official reporting. Also be cautious about lying about age and photos in profiles; honesty is the top dealbreaker in the aggregator list.

No medical, ED, hair or hormone claims. FDA has repeatedly found undeclared sildenafil or tadalafil in "natural" sex supplements, with strokes, kidney failure and deaths reported, and the NIH centre says no herbal product has definite evidence for ED (NBC News; NCCIH). Do not diagnose, name drugs or doses, interpret labs, recommend testosterone, supplements or hair treatments, or imply ED is fixed by confidence; send men to a doctor, since ED can flag heart disease. Pakistan has restricted hakeem and sexual-debility advertising, with unclear enforcement (Journalism Pakistan). Also avoid specific investment, tax or divorce-law advice.

Suicide-safe messaging. Suicide risk is concentrated among older men, and one forum post found in the research carried language suggesting suicidal thoughts. Do not describe methods, do not glamorise, do not frame it as a solution or as inevitable, do not use "just be strong", and show a crisis line on any content about despair, divorce loss or "nobody cares" (988 in the US, local lines elsewhere; the researchers did not verify lines for Pakistan, India or the UK, so confirm them). Do not treat advocacy claims about suicide causes as fact.

AI disclosure and honesty. "Dorian Wolfe" is an AI character, so say so plainly in the bio and in every video. Never invent personal stories, ages, a divorce or "lessons from my marriage". Do not voice the confession format ("I'm 55 and...") as lived experience; speak about what research and men report, or use "men often say". Do not put invented quotes or typical dialogues in men's mouths as if real; label any example "illustrative". Disclose when text is AI-assisted, and do not let the AI imply a human relationship with the viewer.

South Asian specifics. Do not encourage or imply a second marriage can be concealed from a first wife; Pakistani law requires permission and breach carries civil and criminal consequences. Attribute religious rulings to scholars rather than issuing them, do not invent cleric quotes, keep sexual content within platform and legal norms (Pakistani and Indian obscenity and cyber-crime law not verified), and anonymise composites to avoid defamation. Do not adopt the 498A "false case" narrative uncritically. Get a legal check before publishing in Pakistan or India.

Sourcing discipline. Name the study and its limits on screen, and verify every figure at the primary source first. Do not use the flagged figures above.

12. What to verify first

1. **The central statistics you are most likely to say on camera:** AARP 2025 loneliness (49% at 45-49; men 42% vs women 37%), the Pew message-gap figures (64%; 57% vs 24%; 61% vs 44%), and the HRS repartnering figures (37% vs 22%; 55% vs 27%). Reconcile them against the primary pages.
2. **Pew versus AARP on male loneliness and friendship:** the sources conflict, so decide what you will claim and cite both.

3. **FTC and FBI romance-scam numbers and any sex-by-age split** (the FTC Consumer Sentinel explorer is the place); until then do not use the 73% figure.
4. **The Match, Pew and AARP primary reports** for first-date dislikes, length, and dealbreakers by age; retrieve Match's actual over-40 table and the Cleveland Clinic survey, which were not found.
5. **The speed-dating papers' primary text** (Huang et al., Boothby et al., Sprecher et al.) and any 40+ samples; check the "15 questions" and "2,000 conversations" claims before dropping them for good.
6. **Reddit, Facebook group, Instagram and TikTok comment text** for real phrasing: r/FriendsOver40, r/AskMenOver40, r/DivorcedDads, r/widowers and others, using a tool that can reach them. Without it, no real quotes of men 40+ exist in this research.
7. **Men 40-49 specifically:** pull the age cuts in BLS ATUS, Pew and AARP tables, since almost all current figures are 45+, 50+ or all adults.
8. **Bald men:** the real-world evidence (match rates, women's own reports), and the view counts of the claimed bald reels.
9. **South Asian primary sources:** Gallup Pakistan and Pew diaspora data, Urdu and Hindi coverage (Dawn, BBC Urdu, Scroll), a native-speaker pass over male peer talk, idioms and humour, and a short vidIQ pull for Instagram, TikTok and Facebook.
10. **Law:** Pakistan's cyber-crime law and obscenity enforcement, India's bigamy and sexual-content rules, Gulf rules, and custody law, with a local lawyer, before any second-marriage or sexual-health content.
11. **Crisis resources** for each country you target.

Conclusion

The research changes the brief in one way: the most defensible message to men 40+ is not a technique for getting a date but an honest account of what is known, what is guessed and what nobody has measured, delivered by a character who is openly an AI and claims no divorce, bald head or midlife of its own. The strongest evidence points to ordinary behaviour (be curious, take turns, keep old stories short, expect that you are liked more than you fear) and to ordinary pain (loss, thin friendships, money and body worries), while the most exciting hooks (baldness penalties, women's dealbreakers, ghosting rates, locker-room truth) are the claims with the weakest support.

For South Asian audiences the same honesty matters more, because stigma, family reputation and law raise the cost of bad advice, and the only demand signal found is for religious and drama content. A creator who says plainly "this is a lab study of students" or "nobody has measured this" is offering something rare in a crowded niche: a source men over 40 can trust because it does not pretend to know more than it does.

5

35+ CONVERSATION PSYCHOLOGY

Baat karna kyun mushkil hota hai, kaun kya pooche, aur research kya kehti hai (mard aur aurat).



CONVERSATION PSYCHOLOGY FOR DATERS 35+ (USA, CANADA, UK): EVIDENCE FILE FOR WOLFE

Audience: adults about 35+ dating again after divorce, separation, widowhood, a long relationship, or a long single spell. Method note: this is a search-snippet-based review. WebFetch was not used for primary papers and Reddit was not used. Most facts below were read in search-result summaries, not in the full paper or report. Where a number appears, the snippet it came from is named. Anything I could not see is marked "not verified".

Evidence labels: **strong** = meta-analysis, large representative survey, replicated peer-reviewed. **medium** = single solid study, reputable survey, dated source. **anecdotal** = coaching blogs, opinion. **inference** = my reasoning, not a finding.

Bottom line first: there is very little research on first conversations among daters 35+. Most conversation experiments used students or strangers in labs. The "why it is harder" list for 35+ is mostly plausible inference plus coaching opinion. A product can say that honestly.

1. Why conversation can be harder for 35+ daters returning to dating

What has some evidence

THEME	WHAT THE SOURCE SAYS	SOURCE	LABEL
Online dating experiences are mixed	Pew 2023 (US adults who have used dating sites/apps): 53% said their experience was at least somewhat positive; 14% very positive; 48% said they had experienced at least one of four unwanted behaviours. Women were slightly more likely to describe experiences as negative than in 2019 (up 7 points). US only.	Pew Research Center, "Key findings about online dating in the U.S." (Feb 2023), https://www.pewresearch.org/short-reads/2023/02/02/key-findings-about-online-dating-in-the-u-s/ (numbers seen via search summary)	medium to strong (large representative US survey; I saw summaries, not tables)
Harassment gap is larger under 50 than over 50	Pew states the gender gap in harassment is more pronounced among online daters under 50 than 50+. Exact figures for 30-49 not seen. US only.	Pew, "Young women often face sexual harassment online" (2020), https://www.pewresearch.org/short-reads/2020/03/06/young-women-often-face-sexual-harassment-online-including-on-dating-sites-and-apps/ ; and Pew 2023	medium

THEME	WHAT THE SOURCE SAYS	SOURCE	LABEL
Dating apps fatigue / users falling	UK: Ofcom reported UK dating-app users fell in 2024 (Tinder down about 600,000, or 5%; Hinge down 131,000; Bumble down 368,000). This shows lower use, not why. UK only.	Ofcom Online Nation 2024 via https://www.ofcom.org.uk/media-use-and-attitudes/online-habits/swipe-right-this-valentines-day-top-10-online-dating-services-revealed and ITV summary https://www.itv.com/news/2024-11-28/are-we-falling-out-of-love-with-dating-apps	medium (regulator data; the "fatigue" cause is inference)
Repartnering differs by gender, loss type	Studies of US adults after "gray divorce" (50+) show repartnering is more common after divorce than widowhood and that women are more likely to avoid repartnering. Repartnering was linked to less loneliness for men; for women, social support also mattered. US, mostly 50+.	Brown et al., J Health Soc Behav 2019 (https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC6565490); Journals of Gerontology B 2020 (https://hrs.isr.umich.edu/bibcite/reference/15704)	medium
Quality of the new relationship matters for wellbeing	Divorced US mothers who entered high-quality relationships reported wellbeing boosts; those entering lower-quality ones reported lower wellbeing than single mothers. Mothers only, US.	https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5061053/	medium

What is plausible inference or coaching opinion (not directly measured in 35+ daters)

I found no study I could verify that measures each item below in 35+ first-time-in-years daters. Treat all as inference unless noted.

- **Rusty social skills.** Plausible: less recent practice, new platform norms. No measured data found. Label: inference.
- **Guardedness, baggage, trust issues.** Coaching and advice blogs describe divorce leaving people doubting others and second-guessing a date's motives (e.g. Regal Beagle, https://theregalbeagle.beehiiv.com/p/dating-divorce-difficult). Label: anecdotal.
- **Fear of rejection and looking foolish.** Same sources and The Modest Man (https://www.themodestman.com/hidden-dating-fears-men-over-40/) describe fear of being hurt again; some men avoid dating to protect themselves. Label: anecdotal. Related lab evidence on "liking gap" (section 3) suggests people also underestimate how much others like them, so some fear is likely miscalibrated. That link to 35+ daters is inference.
- **Comparing with the ex or late spouse.** Several advice pages (funeral.com, marriage.com) warn against measuring a new person against a former spouse and say wanting a "replica" may signal not being ready. Label: anecdotal.
- **Time scarcity (work, kids).** Very plausible and widely repeated; I did not find a source I could verify that measures it for dating conversations. Label: inference.
- **Small-talk fatigue.** I found no verified research using this term. Label: inference. Do not present as a finding.

- **Negative self-talk about age/body.** Advice blogs mention age stereotypes and self-doubt (e.g. https://vocal.media/confessions/thriving-in-relationships-after-40). Label: anecdotal.
- **Grief and guilt after divorce or widowhood.** Widowhood advice sources describe guilt, rawness in early bereavement, and no universal "right time" (funeral.com; tawkify; pubtic; links in section 5). Label: anecdotal. The 2019 gray-divorce study above is peer-reviewed on depressive symptoms and recovery but does not study dating conversation.

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2. What men and women 35+ tend to find hard to say or ask

Honest caveat: I found no study that asks 35+ men and women "what is hardest to say on a first date." What follows combines survey data on online-dating messaging (US, all ages unless stated) with inference. Do not write gendered claims in a product as "research shows" unless they are from the Pew rows.

How men and women experience online-dating messaging (US)

Source for the numbers: a news summary of Pew's 2023 report (Business Report, https://busrep.co.za/lifestyle/love-sex/relationships/finding-love-sex-and-harassment-on-dating-apps-e3a81ec8-9a5c-4152-b8c5-4b578caedf55), which the search tool returned; the underlying Pew report is "From Looking for Love to Swiping the Field" and "The Experiences of U.S. Online Daters" (Feb 2, 2023, https://www.pewresearch.org/internet/2023/02/02/the-experiences-of-u-s-online-daters/). I did not see the Pew table directly, so the figures below should be rechecked on pewresearch.org before printing.

EXPERIENCE (US ONLINE DATERS, ALL ADULT AGES)	MEN	WOMEN	LABEL
Feel they do not get enough messages	57%	24%	medium to strong; secondary read
Feel they get too many messages	8%	30%	same
Received unsolicited sexual message/image (reported in summary as 46% of women; a different figure, 38% of all online daters, was cited elsewhere)	n/a in snippet	46% (disputed across sources)	unclear, do not quote

The sources disagree on the harassment numbers (46%, 38%, and a Statista 2022 figure of 56% for women 18-49 vs 25% for men). Because of that conflict I recommend quoting only the direction: women are much more likely than men to report harassment and unwanted explicit contact, and the gap is larger under 50. Pew 2020 (primary page seen in results): 60% of women under 35 who online dated said someone kept contacting them after they said no, versus 27% of men under 35. That is under-35s, so it is not a 35+ figure.

Likely difficulties by gender (mostly inference, with data pointers)

Men 35+

- Getting replies at all. Pew shows men are far more likely to feel they receive too few messages (57% vs 24%, see above). Label: medium (data) for "men feel they get too few messages"; the link to what they find hard to say is inference.
- Asking directly for a date without sounding pushy, and showing interest without pressure. Inference.
- Talking about feelings, divorce, or fears. Coaching blogs say some men avoid dating to protect themselves from rejection (The Modest Man, https://www.themodestman.com/?p=751231). Label: anecdotal.
- Gray-divorce research: repartnering especially reduces loneliness for men (Journals of Gerontology B 2020). Label: medium. This is about outcomes, not conversation.

Women 35+

- Saying "no" or "not interested" clearly and safely, because persistent contact after refusal is common for younger women (Pew 2020). For 35+ women the gap is not broken out in what I saw. Label: medium for under-35s; inference for 35-49.
- Handling a high volume of messages (30% of women feel they get too many, Pew 2023 via secondary summary).
- Stating what they want, including pace and exclusivity, without being labelled "too much." Inference.
- Women are more likely to avoid repartnering after gray divorce (study above, 50+, US). Label: medium. Reasons are not conversation-specific.

Both: asking about intentions, saying "I'm nervous," saying "I haven't done this in years," and ending politely. Inference.

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3. What conversation behaviours research supports

All items below come from studies mostly of students, strangers, or general adults, not 35+ daters. Say so in the product.

3.1 Ask questions, especially follow-ups

- **Finding:** Huang, Yeomans, Brooks, Minson and Gino (2017), Journal of Personality and Social Psychology, "It doesn't hurt to ask: Question-asking increases liking." Across studies, people who asked more questions, particularly follow-ups, were better liked. In a speed-dating dataset, people who asked more follow-up questions were more likely to get a second-date "yes" from the partner. People did not anticipate this effect.
- **Sources:** https://www.hks.harvard.edu/centers/cpl/publications/it-doesnt-hurt-ask-question-asking-increases-liking ; https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC6857721/
- **Dispute:** Kluger and Malloy published a critique arguing the speed-dating data should be analysed with a social relations model, that agreeing to a second date is not the same as

liking, and that asking is not the same as listening. The original authors replied in 2019 (JPSP) and stand by the conclusion; a later correction notice says an audit found minor reporting errors but that all conclusions are valid (per the search summaries; I did not read the papers). So this is a **medium** finding with a published methods dispute, not a settled one.

- **Limits:** Speed-dating participants were a small academic sample (US-based, not 35+-specific); I could not verify the sample ages from the snippets. Follow-up question counts in the speed-dating study came from an automated detector.

3.2 The liking gap

- **Finding:** Boothby, Cooney, Sandstrom and Clark (2018), Psychological Science. After conversations, people underestimate how much their partners liked them and enjoyed the conversation. Seen with lab strangers, first-year dorm mates (persisting for months), and members of the public at a workshop. Observers could judge the liking accurately. The authors link it to people being absorbed in worry about what they said.
- **Source:** https://faculty.wharton.upenn.edu/wp-content/uploads/2020/05/The-Liking-Gap-in-Conversations.pdf (found in results; read through summaries only).
- **Label:** medium to strong (several studies; I did not check replications).
- **Limits:** Not romantic first dates specifically as far as the summaries show; not 35+. A safe use: "Many people leave a conversation thinking it went worse than the other person felt."

3.3 Escalating, reciprocal self-disclosure

- **Finding:** Aron, Melinat, Aron, Vallone and Bator (1997), Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin 23(4): pairs of unacquainted people who took turns answering 36 increasingly personal questions reported more closeness than pairs given small-talk questions. The authors themselves said it is unlikely to produce loyalty, dependence or commitment, which take longer.
- **Sources:** https://ggia.berkeley.edu/practice/36_questions_for_increasing_closeness ; summaries at PsychCentral and Futility Closet.
- **Label:** medium (single-lab originating study; summaries only).
- **Limits:** Structured lab task, mostly students, pairs instructed to do it. It is not proof that this feels right on a first date, and the search did not return evidence on when disclosure backfires. Do not claim "36 questions make people fall in love."
- **Practical reading (inference):** match the other person's depth; do not skip ahead.

3.4 Turn-taking

- I did not find a source I could verify on turn-taking for dating conversation. Label: no verified evidence. Common-sense advice (let the other person finish, share roughly equally) can be given as coaching opinion, not research.

4. Who should ask whom: first moves and initiation

Evidence is thin, old, and mostly platform-specific.

CLAIM	SOURCE	LABEL	LIMITS
On OkCupid, men sent a median of about 9-15 first messages versus 3-4 for women (varied by age); women who messaged first were about 2.5 times more likely to get a reply than men who did.	OkCupid data via NYT/CNN-style coverage, 2016 (e.g. https://amp.cnn.com/cnn/2016/03/14/living/okcupid-womens-research-feat ; https://jezebel.com/women-who-message-dudes-first-on-okcupid-are-getting-mo-1763848001)	anecdotal to medium (company data, dated, not peer-reviewed as seen)	One platform, 2015-2016, heterosexual focus, not age-specific.
A McGill study found men about four times more likely than women to send the first message.	Reported in the same coverage	medium (as reported)	I did not see the paper.
Bumble's design requires the woman to message first in straight matches.	News coverage (e.g. https://verilymag.com/relationships/bumble-dating-apps-women-making-the-first-move/)	medium (platform fact)	I found no recent study of how that changes actual outcomes.
Badoo-reported figure: US women most likely to start conversations (36%), Canadian women 25%.	https://www.globaldatinginsights.com/news/badoo-study-looks-at-dating-behaviours-around-the-world/	anecdotal (company survey, date unclear)	Not verified; sponsor-run.

What I could not find: a recent, representative US/Canada/UK survey of what men and women 35+ expect about who makes the first move or who asks for the date. Say that plainly. A safe line: "There is no strong evidence that one gender 'should' go first; people do both, and apps differ."

5. Sensitive topics and how to handle them honestly

Important: I did not find direct Gottman, APA, BACP or CPA guidance on these topics in the searches (a Gottman-specific search returned nothing relevant). What follows is from advice pages and a few academic sources, so most is **anecdotal**. Where I describe an "early vs later" split, it is my synthesis of that advice and common counselling practice, not a researched rule. Do not attribute it to a professional body.

TOPIC	WHAT ADVICE SOURCES SAY	LABEL	SUGGESTED HONEST STANCE
Ex-partner	Talking mostly about an ex on a first date can signal not being ready (iBelieve, https://www.ibelieve.com/relationships/dating-after-forty-how-to-avoid-common-pitfalls.html). Comparing a date to an ex or late spouse is discouraged.	anecdotal	A brief, neutral fact ("I was married for 14 years; it ended two years ago") is fine; save details for later.

TOPIC	WHAT ADVICE SOURCES SAY	LABEL	SUGGESTED HONEST STANCE
Kids	Sources say be cautious about introducing kids to new partners (OurFamilyWizard; one Christian advice column suggests waiting a year or more). An academic chapter on divorced mothers found children's rapport with a partner was associated with later breakup. Dated and narrow.	anecdotal; one chapter medium	Mention that you have kids early (it affects availability); introduce them later, once things are steady. Inference.
Divorce	Healing before dating is a repeated theme.	anecdotal	Say it is in the past; do not litigate it.
Widowhood	Be honest but measured about a late spouse, then move to shared interests (funeral.com). Timing varies widely. Dwelling on the loss throughout can strain a new relationship (marriage.com).	anecdotal	It is fine to say "I'm widowed" early; grief can come up and does not need hiding.
Age	Age stereotypes cause self-doubt (blogs).	anecdotal	Be honest about age in profile and chat. Do not lie.
Work/money	Not found in verified sources beyond cost-of-dating surveys.	no evidence	Light mention early; detail later. Inference.
Health	Not found.	no evidence	Share what affects plans when it becomes relevant. Inference.
"What are you looking for?"	Not found in verified sources.	no evidence	Plain early question; reasonable to ask by the first few dates. Inference.
Exclusivity	Not found.	no evidence	Raise it directly when it starts to matter, not by guessing. Inference.
Intimacy / pace	Not found.	no evidence	Say your pace out loud; consent and comfort matter. Inference.

Other finding to use carefully: recovering from loss varies. A 2019 gray-divorce study found divorced people recovered from elevated depressive symptoms faster than the widowed (https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC6565490). That is population-level, 50+, US; do not apply it to individuals.

6. US, Canada, UK notes

POINT	SOURCE	LABEL	NOTE
UK app reach (2024): Tinder about 1.9m adults, Hinge 1.4m, Bumble 1.1m, Grindr 913k, Badoo 521k. Ofcom also says over half of Plenty of Fish, Badoo and Happn users are 35-54.	Ofcom, https://www.ofcom.org.uk/media-use-and-attitudes/online-habits/swipe-right-this-valentines-day-top-10-online-dating-services-revealed ; Ofcom 2023 via https://www.globaldatinginsights.com/news/ofcom-shares-uk-dating-statistics-for-2023/	medium (regulator, reach not share-of-35+)	UK only. Note the two Ofcom years give different counts.
Ipsos: Hinge users are three quarters 18-34; Bumble has the greatest share of over-35s.	https://iris.ipsos.com/?p=3167	medium	UK context from snippet; verify.
YouGov Dec 2023: 37% of 380 British app users said profiles were appealing.	https://business.yougov.com/content/48146-the-good-the-bad-and-the-ugly-of-dating-apps-in-britain	medium (small sample)	UK only.
US dating data: Pew surveys above.	Pew	medium to strong	US only. No equivalent Canadian or UK survey found.
Canada app usage	Searches returned nothing usable (no Statistics Canada source found).	no evidence	Do not state Canadian app rankings.
Who pays: one guide says men customarily pay first dates in the US and alcohol plays a bigger role in UK dating; Badoo survey said 65% of young GB women like to pick up the tab; a Self Financial US study said men pay more per date and over 60% argued about it.	https://bdae.com/en/magazine/3665-how-dating-differs-from-one-country-to-another ; https://www.cbsnews.com/amp/minnesota/news/women-pick-up-check-first-dates ; https://www.globaldatinginsights.com/news/study-the-financial-costs-of-dating-in-2024/	anecdotal (commentary, company surveys, dated)	Do not claim a national norm. Suggested wording: "Say early who is paying, or split." (inference)
Match.com 2012: 76% of US singles reported two or more dates in the past year, Canada 70%, UK 68%.	https://match.mediaroom.com/2012-07-24-The-Dating-Championships-New-Match.com-Survey-Reveals-Singles-Dating-Behaviors-and-Beliefs-Across-the-Globe	anecdotal (2012, industry survey)	Old; avoid.
Word "date" vs "meet up", safety norms by country	Not found	no evidence	Inference: wording varies by person more than by country; the safety basics (public place, tell a friend) are common advice, not country-specific research.

7. Do not use list (stats and claims I could not verify)

- Any "X% of people over 40 are lonely/afraid/ghosted/unable to date" figure. I found no source.
- "Divorced people over 40 date X times before remarriage," "X% of second marriages fail" or similar. Not verified in this review.
- "It takes N months/years to be ready after divorce/widowhood." Sources say timing varies widely; no research number found.
- "Men 35+ send X messages for every reply" or "women 35+ receive X messages a day." Not found. The only message-volume figures I saw are Pew's all-age numbers via a secondary summary.
- The harassment percentages for women: figures conflicted (46%, 38%, 56%, 60% among under-35). Use direction only.
- "36 questions make you fall in love" and "second date is guaranteed if you ask follow-up questions." Overstates Aron 1997 and Huang 2017.
- "People decide in seven seconds / 3 minutes whether they like you." Not verified.
- "Women who message first get 2.5x more replies" as a current fact. It is 2016 OkCupid data from one platform.
- "Most Canadians use X app" or "UK men pay on first dates." Not found / unverified.
- Gottman, APA, BACP or CPA rulings on dating after divorce or widowhood. I did not find any; do not name them as backing.
- The Jasmine Directory and similar low-quality pages reproduced Pew numbers I could not confirm.

Safe things to say vs do not claim

SAFE THINGS TO SAY IN A PRODUCT	DO NOT CLAIM
"Asking a follow-up question shows you listened. Research on speed daters found people who asked more follow-ups were more liked (one study, disputed on method, not about 35+)."	"Questions guarantee a second date."
"After a conversation, many people think it went worse than the other person felt (the liking gap, Boothby et al. 2018, mostly strangers and students)."	"Everyone likes you more than you think."
"Sharing a little more personal detail as the other person does can build closeness (Aron et al. 1997, lab setting)."	"36 questions make people fall in love."
"US survey data (Pew 2023) show men are far more likely than women to feel they get too few messages, and women are more likely to feel they get too many and to face unwanted contact."	Exact harassment percentages for women 35+; any age-35+ message figures.
"Feeling rusty, guarded, or nervous after a divorce or loss is common according to counselling-style advice; evidence specific to 35+ daters is limited."	"Studies show 35+ daters suffer small-talk fatigue / low self-esteem."

SAFE THINGS TO SAY IN A PRODUCT	DO NOT CLAIM
"A short, honest line about your past is enough on a first date; save the long story."	"Experts say never mention your ex / kids on a first date," or naming Gottman, APA, BACP, CPA as sources.
"Apps differ on who messages first. There is no strong evidence that one person should always go first."	"Women who message first do better" as a present-day fact.
"Say your pace and what you are looking for in plain words."	Specific timelines (months after divorce, number of dates before kissing).
"UK adult use of dating apps fell in 2024, per Ofcom."	"App fatigue is why," or Canadian app rankings.
"Who pays varies; saying it kindly beforehand avoids awkwardness."	"In the UK/US/Canada the man/woman pays."

6

USA / CANADA / UK RESOURCES

Helpline, scam reporting, dating customs. Search results se liye gaye: check karein.



REGIONAL RESOURCES: USA, CANADA, UK (DATING AFTER 35)

Research date: 2026-10-13. Method: WebSearch only (standard mode). WebFetch was not used, so official pages were NOT opened; everything below comes from search-result snippets/summaries, often via secondary sources (directories, news, councils). Treat "verified in search result" as "seen in a search result", not "confirmed on the official site today". Re-check every number and hours before publishing. Nothing here is from memory unless marked.

Status labels: **V** = verified in search result (source named). **NV** = not verified - check before publishing.

Recent changes to flag

- UK: Report Fraud replaced Action Fraud on 4 Dec 2025 for England, Wales and Northern Ireland; phone number 0300 123 2040 reported unchanged; Scotland still uses Police Scotland on 101 (V: gov.uk news story and reportfraud.police.uk "goes live" notice, per search summary; Which? also covered it). Do not publish "Action Fraud" as current.
- US: the 988 "Press 3" LGBTQ+ youth option ended 17 July 2025 (V: SAMHSA statement as reported by CentraCare, Health Policy Ohio, news outlets). 988 itself continues. Veterans (Press 1) and Spanish (Press 2) options reported unaffected. Anything after July 2025 not checked.
- Canada: 9-8-8 launched 30 Nov 2023 (V: news/directory listings). Run by CAMH, funded by PHAC. Not checked for 2026 changes.
- UK 159: bank list changes over time; older alerts list fewer banks (V).
- Men's Advice Line hours conflict between sources; Cruse and CAFC hours also conflict.

1. Reporting romance scams / online fraud

USA

- FTC ReportFraud: reportfraud.ftc.gov - V (named in WBAY/12News-type consumer articles; FTC page not itself in results). Phone not found - NV.
- FBI Internet Crime Complaint Center (IC3): www.ic3.gov - V (FBI field-office press release in results). FBI advice: stop contact, tell your financial institution immediately about any transfer, file with IC3.
- Stats seen (cite with year, secondary or FBI office): IC3 2022: 19,000+ romance complaints, almost $740M losses (FBI New York page, V). FTC: nearly 70,000 reports and $1.3B lost in 2022 (secondary article, V); $1.14B in 2023 (local news citing FTC, V). Agencies count differently. 2024/2025 figures not found.

Canada

- Canadian Anti-Fraud Centre (CAFC): toll-free 1-888-495-8501; reporting page antifraudcentre-centreantifraude.ca/report-signalez-eng.htm. V via directory listings (211 Saskatchewan, Healthline, CIOC), not the CAFC site. Hours conflicting (most say Mon-Fri 10:00-16:45 ET; one says 9:00 start) - NV on hours.
- RCMP advice: report any scam to the CAFC even if not a victim; contact local police if money lost (V: rcmp-grc.gc.ca).
- Stats: CAFC counted over $58.4M lost to romance fraud in 2024 (Shelburne Free Press, secondary, V); $50M in 2023 (CTV News headline, V).

UK

- Report Fraud: reportfraud.police.uk, 0300 123 2040 (England, Wales, NI). V. Scotland: 101. V. Report Fraud does not investigate cases or give progress updates (V, one source).
- Bank fraud line 159 (Stop Scams UK): dial 159 to reach your own bank's fraud team; you start the call, 159 never calls you; cost per your provider; stopscamsuk.org.uk/159. V. Check the bank list on the official page.
- Which?: published explainer "Report Fraud: what does this new era of fraud reporting mean" (V, title/URL only). No Which? romance-scam phone line found.
- Emergency 999 for immediate danger (V, councils).

2. Crisis and emotional support

COUNTRY	SERVICE	HOW TO CONTACT	STATUS
USA	988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline	Call or text 988; chat at 988lifeline.org/chat; 24/7, free; English and Spanish; 240+ languages via interpreter; Deaf/HoH can text/chat	V (state health dept/NY OMH, AZDHS, UCLA pages; not 988lifeline.org itself)
USA	Legacy 1-800-273-8255	Sources conflict on whether still active	NV - do not publish
Canada	9-8-8 Suicide Crisis Helpline	Call or text 988; 24/7; English and French; TTY via 711 then 988; Video Relay for Deaf; info at 988.ca	V (listings, CMHA, CHCH; not Canada.ca)
UK	Samaritans	116 123, free, 24/7	V (NHS/council pages)
UK	Shout	Text SHOUT to 85258	V (council/NHS pages); free-of-charge and hours not stated in results - NV
UK	NHS 111 mental health	Dial 111, choose option 2; online 111.nhs.uk	V (NHS trust and council pages); option number may vary by area - NV
UK	Emergency	999	V

3. Domestic abuse / safety

USA

- National Domestic Violence Hotline: 1-800-799-SAFE (7233); text START to 88788; video phone for Deaf callers 855-812-1001; thehotline.org; 24/7; 200+ languages per a directory. V (thehotline.org pages in results). Site warns internet use can be monitored. Men-specific US line: not searched - NV.

Canada

- No single national hotline (V: Women and Gender Equality Canada "Get help now" page links to provincial/territorial lines). Emergency 911.
- ShelterSafe.ca: online map of shelters, each with a 24-hour number; sheltersafe.ca/get-help. V. Shelter counts differ (600+ vs 350+ member shelters) - do not quote a count.
- Examples seen on the Canada.ca page: Alberta Family Violence Info Line 310-1818; Victim Link BC 1-800-563-0808. V.
- Assaulted Women's Helpline (Ontario only, women 16+): 1-866-863-0511, TTY 1-866-863-7868, #7233 on Bell/Rogers/Fido/Telus mobile; 24/7. V (directory listings, not the AWHL site). Do not present as national.
- Men-specific Canadian service: none found - no source found.
- Other-province lines: not searched - NV.

UK

- National Domestic Abuse Helpline (run by Refuge): 0808 2000 247, free, 24/7. V (council/PCC/Bristol Uni pages).
- Men's Advice Line: 0808 801 0327, for men experiencing abuse from a partner or ex. V, but hours conflict (Mon-Fri 9am-8pm vs older 10-1/2-5) - NV on hours.
- If you cannot speak on 999: press 55 (council page, V - single source).

4. Relationship and grief support

- Relate (UK): relate.org.uk, local centres set fees. Seen: roughly GBP 48-88 per session (Hereford/Worcester, Severn and Wye); GBP 60-65 (Coventry/Warwickshire); GBP 92 standard after assessment at one London-area centre; sliding scale and bursaries at some centres. V for local pages; prices dated, NV for current fees.
- Cruse Bereavement Support (UK): helpline 0808 808 1677; free; volunteer-based; hours conflict (9:30-3 Mon-Fri vs longer, Tuesday evening) - number V (listings), hours NV. cruse.org.uk.
- Widowed and Young (WAY, UK): peer support for people widowed at 50 or under (or before 51 - sources differ); membership via signup. V; check eligibility wording. Not suited to all readers over 35.

- DivorceCare (US/Canada): church-hosted 13-week video groups; find at divorcecare.org; fee varies (one listing $20, some free). V (church/community listings).
- GriefShare (US/Canada): same format for death bereavement; griefshare.org; US phone 800-395-5755 appeared in a listing. V (secondary), phone NV. Faith-based - note for secular readers.
- Bereaved Families of Ontario - Toronto: free peer-led bereavement support, 416-440-0290. V (Healthline listing), local only.
- US widowed-specific free service: no source found. Canada national widowed or divorce counselling directory: no source found. Relate has no verified phone number in results.

5. Official online-dating safety guidance: red flags named

Caveat: FTC, CAFC, Report Fraud and NCSC pages did not appear in results. Lists below come from secondary reports of those agencies or from other official bodies, so label accordingly.

- US (FTC, via local news; FBI via field-office releases):
  - Professes love or marriage fast, before meeting.
  - Always has excuses not to meet or video call.
  - Asks for money, especially crypto, wire or gift cards.
  - Claims to be military/overseas/oil rig; invents emergencies (sick relative, jail).
  - Pitches "investment" teaching.
  - Stolen or AI photos (reverse image search), thin online presence, typos.
  - FBI: wants to move off the dating site to email/messaging immediately.
- Canada (RCMP page, police services; Canadian Centre for Cyber Security getcybersafe.gc.ca "Spot romantic red flags" PDFs in results):
  - Declares love before meeting; love bombing within days or weeks.
  - Pushes to move to private channels.
  - Always has a reason not to meet or video call; blurry, recycled photos.
  - Says they live nearby but are overseas.
  - Urgent money requests (travel, medical, family); crypto investment pitches.
  - Discourages you from telling friends or family.
- UK: Report Fraud and NCSC guidance NOT found in results - NV, check before publishing. Essex Police (via essex.gov.uk) names overseas military/medical claims; Europol (not UK) advises never sending money or documents and telling someone where you are going to a first meeting. Do not attribute these to Report Fraud or NCSC.

6. Most-used dating apps

- USA - Pew Research Center, survey July 2022, 6,034 adults, published Feb 2023 (V, high confidence for 2022, dated). Ever used, share of all adults: Tinder 14%, Match 9%, Bumble 8%, OkCupid 6%, eharmony 6%, Hinge 6%, Grindr 2%, HER 1%. Among online daters: Tinder 46%, Match 31%, Bumble 28%, OkCupid/eharmony/Hinge about 20% each. No newer Pew app data found. Age 35+ breakdown not seen in results.
- UK - Ofcom, May 2024 adult reach (V via press summaries of Ofcom; medium confidence): Tinder about 1.9M, Hinge 1.4M, Bumble 1.1M, Grindr 913k, Badoo 521k. Users skew male (65/35). Over half of Plenty of Fish, Badoo and Happn users are 35-54 (useful for this audience). Grindr most popular among 54+. Secondary sources give different 2023 numbers. 2025 or 2026 Ofcom figures not found.
- Canada - no reputable ranking found. A low-quality site says Tinder, Bumble, Hinge, citing Statista without figures. Confidence low; do not publish without a better source. Statista US user survey (Tinder 37%, Bumble 35% of app users, past 12 months) seen - US only, V but paywalled.

7. First-date etiquette

- Who pays: all surveys are self-selected or commissioned, differing methods, so low-to-medium confidence.
  - US: YouGov poll - 35% say man should always pay, 32% say whoever initiated (V, YouGov). DatingAdvice.com survey of 950+ single Americans - 53% say splitting is the new normal (V, commercial).
  - UK: Aquacard survey of 700+ adults - 27% most common answer is split evenly (V, commercial lender); Badoo survey - 65% of young GB women like to pick up the tab (V, app-commissioned).
- Tipping US vs Canada vs UK: no source found (the search returned nothing on tipping rates).
- Meeting in public / telling someone where you are going: Europol advises telling family or friends where you are going (V, but not US/CA/UK). No US/CA/UK government source seen.
- Ghosting norms: no source found.

Ready-to-copy Regional resources table

COUNTRY	PURPOSE	NAME	CONTACT	VERIFICATION STATUS
USA	Report scam	FTC ReportFraud	reportfraud.ftc.gov	V (secondary mention); phone NV
USA	Report internet crime	FBI IC3	www.ic3.gov	V (FBI press release)

COUNTRY	PURPOSE	NAME	CONTACT	VERIFICATION STATUS
USA	Crisis / suicide	988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline	Call or text 988; 988lifeline.org/chat	V (state/univ pages); Press 3 LGBTQ+ youth option ended 17 Jul 2025
USA	Domestic abuse	National Domestic Violence Hotline	1-800-799-7233; text START to 88788; thehotline.org	V (thehotline.org)
USA	Divorce support	DivorceCare	divorcecare.org (local church groups)	V (listings); fees vary
USA	Grief support	GriefShare	griefshare.org; 800-395-5755	URL V; phone NV
Canada	Report scam	Canadian Anti-Fraud Centre	1-888-495-8501; antifraudcentre-centreantifraude.ca	V (directories); hours NV
Canada	Report scam / police	Local police or RCMP	Local number	V (RCMP page)
Canada	Crisis / suicide	9-8-8 Suicide Crisis Helpline	Call or text 988; 988.ca	V (listings; launched 30 Nov 2023)
Canada	Domestic abuse	ShelterSafe	sheltersafe.ca/get-help	V (search result)
Canada	Domestic abuse (Ontario)	Assaulted Women's Helpline	1-866-863-0511; #7233	V (directories); Ontario only
Canada	Domestic abuse (provincial list)	Women and Gender Equality Canada crisis lines	canada.ca/en/women-gender-equality/gender-based-violence/crisis-lines.html	V (search result)
Canada	Grief (Toronto)	Bereaved Families of Ontario - Toronto	416-440-0290	V (listing); local only
UK	Report fraud	Report Fraud (replaced Action Fraud 4 Dec 2025)	reportfraud.police.uk; 0300 123 2040; Scotland 101	V (gov.uk, reportfraud.police.uk)
UK	Bank fraud	159 (Stop Scams UK)	Dial 159; stopscamsuk.org.uk/159	V; check participating banks
UK	Crisis / suicide	Samaritans	116 123	V
UK	Crisis text	Shout	Text SHOUT to 85258	V
UK	Urgent mental health	NHS 111	111, option 2; 111.nhs.uk	V; option number may vary by area
UK	Domestic abuse	National Domestic Abuse Helpline (Refuge)	0808 2000 247	V

COUNTRY	PURPOSE	NAME	CONTACT	VERIFICATION STATUS
UK	Domestic abuse (men)	Men's Advice Line	0808 801 0327	V; hours NV
UK	Relationship counselling	Relate	relate.org.uk (local centres)	V; fees vary and NV
UK	Bereavement	Cruse Bereavement Support	0808 808 1677; cruse.org.uk	V; hours NV
UK	Young widowed	Widowed and Young (WAY)	membership signup	V; eligibility wording conflicts
All	Emergency	911 (US/CA), 999 (UK)	-	V (911 on Canada.ca/Alberta context; 999 on UK council pages); US 911 not directly sourced - NV